NO INTEREST FOR MONEY,

EXCEPT TO THE GOVERNMENT;

THEN NOT TO EXCEED 3 PER CENT.

UNCLE SAM, BANKER:

THE WEALTH OF THE COUNTRY, INCLUDING SOIL, MINERALS AND THE PRODUCTIONS, THE CAPITAL STOCK.

PROFITS PLACED TO THE CREDIT OF THE PEOPLE

AFTER PAYING GOVERNMENT EXPENSES.

SHYLOCK AND HIS MONEY CAST OUT; FOR THE PEOPLE CAN HAVE BETTER MONEY, MORE OF IT, AND A BANK THAT WILL NOT BREAK; ALL DEPOSITS SAFE; NO "HARD TIMES" NOR REVOLUTIONS.

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BY W. H. GIBBS, LYONS, IOWA.

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PREFACE.

Labor produces silks, broadcloths, calf boots, stove pipe hats, carriages, mansions, as well as all food, raiment and shelter. Why don't producers have an abundance of those things? Because our financial system, protected by law, transfers production from the producer to the non-producer. We have paid enough interest on money to support three families of our size comfortably through life. Observe the masses struggling to live, who by constant labor and economy, only secure a bare subsistance, while non-producers, who loan money, amass great fortunes, led us to study political economy. We find that usury in the Bible means any money paid for the use of money; and that most nations down to about the middle of the fifteenth century confisicated the property of those who took money for the use of money. The Jews, who would sell father and mother, and even Christ, for money—even deal in *pork* to get gain—instituted a monetary system to rob the producing power of the world. In Great Britain, during the reign of Henry the VIII, about 1530, they came to London and instituted banking. The King smiled upon the institution. Decrees or legal enactments were passed allowing interest on money. Now, usury means above legal rates. John Calvin favored the new departure. It is a fact in history that before this period extreme want, suffering and poverty were unknown in England. In France during the reign of Louis XIV, Jews and Calvinites went to Paris, set up banking, and obtained the good graces of the King, who borrowed money to carry on successful wars. Subsequently interest accumulated the surplus production of the people, and transferred the same into the hands of the Jews and their allies. As in England the people were oppressed, which culminated in the reign of terror. The same causes are producing the same results in Germany, especially Berlin, where the wealth of the nation has accumulated by interest into the coffers of the Jews and semi-Jews. A revolution is imminent. The same results are duplicated in New York City. Wall Street controls the government and oppresses the people. A monetary system that hampers, perplexes and robs the producers of all wealth, will end in ruin to both people and government.

The acquisition of property by labor will hardly average two or two and one-half per cent. per annum. Laws favoring the Jewish system of finance, where by interest is taken over two or two and one-half per cent., not only discourages those who toil, but strikes terror and death to the producing power of all wealth. As money was instituted to measure the value of production in the exchange of barter and distribute property to whom it belongs—as it does not possess an accumulating power, no pay inheres for the use of this measure any more than for the use of the yard stick or other measures. Law declaring money a commodity, and interest for its use, builds up monopoly and peasantry, master and slave, just as certainly as two and one make three. The Jews would not have the people by the throat were it not for the complete net work of laws that protect them. This is the most important subject producers can consider, for it bears directly upon their success and happiness in life. When fully understood the Jews will be laid out straighter than a "loon's leg." Modern writers upon "political economy," viz, Wayland, Adam Smith and others, seem to throw a veil of mystery over the world's financial system.—"Over production," never! if there is ability to purchase. If an over production produces distress, then God's government is a failure, for we are commanded to be fruitful and multiply and replenish the earth.

We think a monetary system may be inaugurated as simple as addition, subtraction and multiplication, which will distribute property to the producers thereof, and will introduce friendly feeling in society and harmony in the government. We have never been a politician, for we never held an office in our life, except once a *distinguished* Alderman in a little city, and then received no pay, but many kicks. Perhaps we should state that formerly an Abolitionist, and lately a Republican. Now we do not belong to any party, although some say our back is green. No man is fit to be a Republican who votes for party. No man is fit to be a Democrat who is wedded to party. All should vote for principle. Not hampered in any way, we have been collecting material for a new monetary system. Our friends urged us to abridge and present in a cheap form a few thoughts upon this subject, so we have thrown together a few crude ideas for producers to consider. In another work we shall try to answer all objections to our theory and present the same for the criticism of the public.

NO INTEREST ON MONEY.

In Smith's old arithmetic we find: "An English penny put at compound interest in the year one, at 5 per cent., up to the year 1810, would amount to more than could be expressed, — viz., 357,000,000 of globes, each equal to the earth, all of solid gold."

An expert mathematician in Connecticut has figured: "One cent at simple interest for 1,870 years would amount to $112; and that a cent at compound for the same time would amount to $2,008,785,469,721,770,280,517,336,007,361,941,519,773,773,447."

As compound interest will swallow up God's universe—more than we can comprehend—let us come down to human capacity.

The thirteen original Colonies contained 153,835,520 acres of land. Suppose England had sold it to the pilgrims in 1620 at one cent per acre ($1,538,355), on long time, at 6 per cent compound. To-day (258 years) it would amount to $2,177,588,274,960. The assessed value of real estate in the United States was $14,500,000,000 in 1870; in connection with all other property, about thirty billions. The pilgrims would have paid, or owed, England $2,147,588,264,960 more than the assessed value of the United States in 1870.

One hundred thousand dollars put out at 10 per cent., compound, will amount to $1,638,-400,000 in ninety-eight years. B. R. Sherman, Auditor of State, informed me last November that the total assessed value of Iowa, for 1877, was $404,670,044, which is less by $1,233,729,-956 than the interest on $100,000, for ninety-eight years, as above computed.

The accumulation of interest has enabled the Rothschilds to purchase Empires. It is said the income of the Vanderbilt estate is $5,250,000. The labor of 21,000 men at $250 per annum will be required to pay this income; this does not include their living, for *mules* must be fed while their surplus earnings go to their owners. Good Lord, deliver us!

The yard-stick measures length; half-bushel, quantity; sacks, bulk; weights, pounds. "Money measures values," is the testimony of all political economists. Gold has no intrinsic value, except such of it as we can put in our teeth or use in mechanical and ornamental purposes. Potatoes and cabbage have intrinsic value; they help to sustain life. Gold, the law declares, shall represent the value of production or property that preserves life. The adoption of gold, silver, or paper, as money, is to facilitate exchange. The real use of money is to represent values. The money of a nation represents the wealth of the nation. Its use is to "measure values." Money does not draw interest. If a man give his note drawing interest for money, with an endorser whose property is collateral security, his note draws the interest. Surplus production by labor pays it. The increase

comes from industry. The money does not increase or produce; it measures the value of production. The man who borrows money and pays interest pays for the use of the representative of his property. Pay for the use of this "measure" does not *inhere* to money, any more than for the use of other measures. Law requiring pay for the use of the representative or measure of property does great injustice to the producing classes of the world. Let us try the case. The increase of property in the United States for the last 100 years has been a fraction less than 2½ per cent. Political economists tell us that the average profit of American labor is 2½ per cent.

When 10 per cent. (we leave out semi-annual compounds) interest is paid, law requires 7½ per cent of the blood and muscle of men to flow into the pockets of non-producers, who are as fat and sleek as Henry Clay's negroes. Law, then, builds up an aristocracy in this Republic, the land of the free and the brave. The proportion of this aristocracy to the whole is about 3 per cent. Statistics show that more than one-half of the wealth of the State of New York is owned by 2½ per cent of its people, most of whom reside in Wall street. More than one-half of the property of the United States is owned by about 3 per cent. of its inhabitants, many of whom are millionaires. The proportion is about the same as drone bees to the bee-hive.

Interest, the sum of all villainies, enables the few to live in splendor, luxury, and ease from the surplus production of the many. Interest

has created caste, and built up partition walls in human society; *i. e.*, labor furnished all the material and did all the work to build up an aristocracy of non-producers. Originally, money was used simply as a "measure"—a medium of exchange—no pay being required for its use, any more than for yard-stick or half-bushel. This was in harmony with its natural functions. The Mosaic law condemned the right of taking interest. "Usury," in the Bible, is anything paid for the use of money. Legal enactments forbade it, in most of the nations, down to the reformation. John Calvin did more to fasten the infernal curse of interest on civilized society than any other *one* man; this we will show hereafter. Cast-iron mortgages, drawing high rates of interest, are in harmony with his cast-iron creed and doctrine of election.

TIN-PAIL NOBLEMEN.

Who penetrates the mountains for precious metals? Ans.: The man who carries the tin pail.

Who are the advanced guard to develop a new country? The men who carry the tin pails.

Who build our railroads, steamboats, engines, ware and station houses, and keep the same in repair? The tin pails.

Who build cities, our houses, and work up fuel for the same? The tin pails.

Who build our roads and bridges? The tin pails.

Who supply clothing and food for the human race? The tin pails.

Who have produced all the wealth (fruits of labor) of the world? The tin pails.

Who support aristocrats in their extravagance? The tin pails.

Who fight the battles of the nation, and live on hard-tack? The tin pails.

Who are the *noble men of earth?* Those who carry the tin pail.

God bless the old tin pail.

NATURE'S LAW.

Placed upon this earth, so changeable from scorching heat to stinging cold, having a body, living and dying all the time, recuperating and decaying, subject to ten thousand conditions, it is a desperate struggle to supply the wants and necessities of life. Nature's law is that each person, with hands and head produce equivalent to what he consumes; if he does not, he falls in debt to friends or society. Nature declares, in language brighter than the sun, that every person by *honest toil* is entitled to the benefit of his own labor, for his own happiness. Society has no right to take any part thereof, except what will "better secure his natural rights." The cost of maintaining good government should be equally borne by all. Any regulation in society, cemented by legal enactments, that takes from labor the surplus production which labor earned and needs, is a wrong to those who by labor support all

Self-preservation is the first law of nature. The man who by labor supplies his own wants, and furnishes his quota for the maintenance of good government, is most certainly entitled to the benefits of nature's first law. Interest on money strikes at the very heart of this law, because it takes from another the necessities of life, without an equivalent. The result is that the r h grow richer without toil, and the poor, who do labor, grow poorer. What is the cause of this great disparity in human society? It is because money is made a commodity; interest is charged for the use of the "measure" of production. If money represents the value of commodities, it should not be a commodity itself. This is the hinge of the question. Money, a dead thing, possesses no vital force to increase; its use is to "measure" vitality. To charge for the use of a dead thing, not productive, for mesuring a live thing—*i. e.*, possessing the elements of vitality—is unjust, and a great wrong inflicted upon those laboring to support the human race. Charging for the use of this measure by separating production from labor, this tool of labor is collected and loaned or rented back to labor at such high rates of interest that it is next to an imposibility for labor to keep its head above water. It strikes death to the vital forces of industry. Being hoarded up and held for high rates of interest, requiring "gilt-edge" security for thirty, sixty or ninety days, with a mortgage stronger and tighter than any iron vise ever made by man, hast hrown a shadow over every industry, while it is constant sunshine with the money-lender.

The cry is that money is scarce. There is plenty of it hoarded up, seeking whom it may devour. If there was no pay for the use of this "measure," the billions of money now idle would go begging for labor to use, and share equitably in the products of labor, from which all wealth is derived.

WALL STREET.

Statistics show that about 3 per cent. of capitalists own more wealth than the 97 per cent., in the State of New York. About the same ratio prevails in other States. Wall street, with its money, has done more to corrupt the people of the United States than any other cause. Production has been separated from labor and hoarded and used to crush rather than aid labor. Money, although it has no power or vitality to increase in and of itself, any more than brass or parchment, has been so skillfully used in accumulating the surplus production that about 3 per cent. own as much property as the 97 per cent. of the people of the United States. Interest on the money accumulated by the few has gobbled up the surplus production of the millions who toil. This accumulation of the fruits of labor is used for base purposes, tending to corrupt rather than strengthen the virtues of an enslaved people. Let us try the case. Some twenty-three years ago, petitions were presented Congress for four contemplated railroads across the State of Iowa. We were interested, and watched the checker-board

closely. The President of the Iowa Central Air Line, S. S. jones, informed us that the project would win, for the capitalists of Wall street expected to furnish money, in view of finally owning the road, and that Wall street was at work manipulating members of Congress. Congress voted grants of land to the four roads. At a meeting of the Directors of our road, we were elected Land Commissioner. Six hundred thousand acres of land were put in our hands in trust for the railroad company. Mr. Jones informed the Directors that he had agreed with certain Congressmen to give them bonds on the road to the amount of 33 per cent. of the value of the lands at $1.25 per acre. This was nearly twenty-four years ago. The gigantic bribes, Credit Mobilier, etc., since, would almost "skunk" satan.

In the time of trouble at the dawn of our civil war, the people, without means—for capitalists, by excessive interest, had absorbed the surplus production of the country—were obliged to get on their knees and beg of Wall street, who had their earnings, to help save the country. The people would furnish muscle, fight the battles, and live on hard-tack, if Wall street would only lend back some of their hard toil to sustain the government. Wall street, having no motive but interest, dictated to the people: "If the government will issue bonds, put them on the market, and not tax them for the support of government, we will purchase and let the people have *our* money." What security did the bondholders have? The same security that is always given for the *measure* of labor—

the property of the people was held for it; labor, or production, pays the interest, and finally the principal. Money, notes and bonds represent the property of the people. The sale of those bonds was at from 33 to 80 cents on the dollar. The shrinkage comes out of labor. The result is that some of the bondholders have accumulated immense fortunes, bloated, arrogant and despotic, while the people, who support all, are on the verge of bankruptcy. The profits made on the old Vanderbilt "hulks," by the regular committees in Congress, were colossal. Wall street has set an example of gambling which is now imitated in every large city by Boards of Trade. It can buy 1,000 Chicago *Times* to do its dirty work. This Sodom dictates National and State legislation. Money pays Legislatures for legalizing iron collars, fetters and chains for the people. Laws are made in the interest of this money power. Courts, lawyers, officers, prisons, and a standing army of bayonets terrify the 97 per cent. of the people, who are but putty in the hands of their masters, who constitute but 3 per cent. of the population, as above shown. When this subject shall be fully understood, the money power will not amount to even a puff-ball under the foot of an elephant. If a wall could be built around Wall street as high as heaven and as deep as hell (close by), it would be a blessnig to our Republic. We do not declare all who deal in money "cutthroats," for of our acquaintance we know of some good men. We are here speaking of the representatives of the wealth of the country.

"Will any Wall-streeter get to Heaven?" is a question frequently asked. Doubtful; but if so they would be likely to dig up the gold in the streets, go into banking, and require the people to put up the pearly gates as collateral. No! its "bulls" and "bears" are too mean to go to hell, unless they give security for good behavior.

INTEREST A HARD MASTER.

Interest is the worm that gnaws unceasingly into the vitals of industry. It outnumbers the grasshoppers on the plains. It consumes seven-eights of the products of busy hands. It brings ruin upon thousands of enterprises every year. Nearly every dollar in circulation is drawing interest from somebody, and the little that does not is being withdrawn by evil-doers to give place to that which will. The largest proportion of tilled lands is infested with interest. Towns, cites, counties, States, and even the nation, are all drained by interest. The great mass of busy people, and all the homes that are mortgaged, are victims of this insatiable worm—interest. It is the greatest curse entailed upon labor in our age and civilization. To get rid of it should exercise the best energies of every lover of his race, every patriot of his country. The vicious schemes through which it fastens itself upon all public enterprises should be opposed. Our industries are nearly paralyzed, millions of our country-

men are impoverished and made dependent, and our very national existence is endangered by this curse of curses—interest. Keep yourself free from its fangs, if you would enjoy the products of your own labor and enterprise.

UNFORTUNATE FARMERS.

We learn from an undoubted source that the farmers in Northwestern Iowa, Minnesota, and Nebraska, in consequence of a failure in the wheat crop, are borrowing money to live on through the winter, paying rates of interest (taken out in advance) of from 20 to 40 per cent, and all of whom are obliged to mortgage their farms upon cutthroat conditions, some of them also being required to add stock and furniture to get a little of the representative of their property. It is only a matter of time for those mortgages to grind these farmers as much finer than flour as flour is finer than powder. Who can describe the anxiety, perplexity, sorrow, and grief of those unfortunate farmers, caused by *devouring interest*, by greedy and selfish money-lenders? Happier would they be in the Penitentiary than on their farms. In attempting to describe the condition of these farmers, we find ourselves in a somewhat similar predicament to the Boston coal-dealer, who was noted for his swearing propensities and the utterance of terrible oaths. While ascending a hill with a load of coal, some mischievous boys slyly pulled out the end-board of his wagon-box. At the top of the hill the driver looked back, saw coal scattered for four

or five blocks, and was so bewildered he never uttered a word. The boys asked him why he did not swear. He replied that swearing would not do the subject justice. As we cannot do justice in describing the hell those farmers are in, we leave it for the imagination of the reader.

PAYING INTEREST.

BY HENRY WARD BEECHER.

No blister draws sharper than interest does. Of all industries none is comparable to interest. It works all day and night, in fair weather and foul. It makes no noise, but travels fast. It gnaws at a man's substance with invisible teeth. It binds industry with its film, as a fly is bound in a spider's web. Debts roll a man over and over, binding hand and foot, and letting him hang upon the fatal mesh until the long-legged interest devours him. There is but one on a farm like it, and that is the Canada thistle, which swarms new plants every time you break its roots, whose blossoms are prolific, and every flower the father of a million seeds; every leaf is an awl, every branch a spear, and every plant like a platoon of bayonets, and a field of them like an armed host. The whole plant is a torment and vegetable curse. And yet a farmer had better make his bed of Canada thistles than attempt to be at ease upon interest.

NEVER GIVE A MORTGAGE.

Millions of men in this country have, by hard toil, accumulated from $500 to $3,000 in money,

and, with this start in life, concluded to settle down, engage in farming, manufacturing, or go into trade. The *hawks*, who by devouring interest catch the chickens, encourage the man who has $500 or $800 to buy a farm worth $1,000. He, the hawk, will *accommodate* the young man by lending him $500 on three or four years' time, by paying 10 per cent., the usual interest, semi-annually in advance, and take a mortgage on the farm. The young man agrees in note and mortgage to confess judgment, pay all court fees, and allow foreclosure at any time, if he shall fail to pay the interest. The young man, with high hopes and a young wife, with good prospects of an heir to his farm, starts out on a tempestuous sea. Sickness comes, causing a heavy doctor's bill to pay. Crops fail, and the interest is not paid. By begging, an extension is *graciously granted* for six months. When the time expires the young man is no better off, and perhaps not as well, as when he secured the *great favor of extension*. Discouraged and disheartened, he lets the farm go, with the four or five years of toil which he had put into it, and himself, wife, and babe are turned out in the cold. A thousand books as large as the Bible would not be enough to record all the results in our land, of such mortgages and interest. We say never mortgage your property unless dire necessity requires it. If you mortgage your property, mortgage to yourself—*i. e.*, the government, of which you are a part, which should give long time at reasonable rates of interest. The 97 per cent., the producers of our land, can inaugurate

this equitable money system whenever they please, and they will when it is fully understood. We say again, don't borrow money until the laws favor the borrower as well as lender. When that time shall have come, what an impetus it will give to industry! what a rush from our large cities to take up land and improve it for a home—"Home, sweet home!" Knowing that the money power of the nation will help instead of injure them, then will young men be induced to marry. Now they say, "We see so many families wrecked by devouring interest, we will not make an innocent young lady miserable; besides, we do not wish to raise slaves for our masters, the money power." Wise conclusion! When a just and equitable money system shall have been adopted, all will be induced to own some of the productive property of the nation, from which all wealth is derived; for with this system money can be had with profit to both lender and borrower, the nation and the people. Then five hours' labor in the day will secure the necessities of life; then man can have the *honey* he has produced (his living and the common burden of society excepted), as a reserve for the exigencies of life; then, and not until then, will human life be in harmony with Nature's law.

THE MORTGAGE.

BY LIZZIE HULL.

Ten years—and the hair on my temples
  Is turning and mixing with gray,
And my face has grown aged and care-worn,
  Its lines deepen day by day;
My comrades are want and privation,
  They've clung to me close for years,
And I've borne them with unflinching patience,
  Though laden with trouble and fears.

This eve, while the sun has been dipping
  His rays down the fair, rosy west,
I've been over the farm I once planted,
  With hope of serene age and rest;
But to-morrow a white-covered wagon,
  On its long westward journey will start,
And Mary will smile, though she's hiding
  A weary and desolate heart.

I've walked the last time through the orchard;
  This autumn its first fruit will yield;
The vineyard is laden with clusters,
  And yellow with corn is each field,
When full of youth's hope and ambition,
  My wife and I left dear old Maine,
With only the blood boughten pittance
  I'd saved from a "private's" poor gain.

But Mary was happy and cheerful,
  And I strong with vigorous health;
With eighty good acres of prairie,
  We seemed on a short road to wealth;
  So first, for a home and a shelter,
A poor little shanty was built;
  How poor, but one room, and unplastered,
  So meager is poverty felt.

Then stables, and horses, and cattle,
  And harrows, and wagons, and seed,
And hundreds etceteras unthought of,
  That ever a pioneer needs.
And everything came at the highest,
  And called on my small stock of cash.
Till I found, ere I'd half done with buying,
  My dollars had gone like a flash.

For five dreary, desolate winters,
  With summers of labor between,
We suffered, yet thankful if autumn
  Rewarded with measures of grain;
And there, in that kitchen and parlor
  And chamber combined, one bright morn—
With poverty everywhere 'round them—
  Our little twin children were born.

And later our Mabel, our idol,
  Came to us, yet soon fled away;
And we felt there are griefs that are greater
  Than want—that sad burial day.
But I built to the house an "addition,"
  And made things all cosy and warm;
And bought forty acres of "timber,"
  And for it we mortgaged the farm.

Then "hard times" grew harder, and ever
  Misfortune has followed alway,
With failure on failure of harvests
  That no mortal foresight could stay.
The mortgage is closed, and our homestead
  Is gone for its half, and is sold;
No help—for it's law, so it's justice—
  And avarice clutches his gold.

So out—heaven help us!—we wander;
  Our youth and our labors are lost;
Ah! little dreamed we when we signed it,
  The anguish that mortgage would cost.
Out over the prairie to-morrow
  A white-covered wagon will roam,
And eyes that are misty andblinded
  Shall take a last look at "the home."

SINNERS.

The greatest sinners on earth are those who take exorbitant interest, because they produce the most misery. What shall the sufferers do about it? They should use no violence, for we are taught in the good book that we should go down to the very gates of hell to save a brother. Those who are oppressing the industry of the land are our brothers. It is our duty to teach them to do as they would be done by—point them to the Word of God. If the 97 per cent. who are producers were so disposed, they could compel a change of situation between the money power and the laboring classes; but it would not be right, for they (the money power) obtained their gains—the hard earnings of others—through the *law*; besides, we have no moral right to oppress anybody. We were created to help each other. But it is a duty that producers owe to themselves not to allow any more oppression from the money power—*i. e.*, laws should be changed so as to favor those who produce the wealth of the nation. Stand up for the right and do right; for one with God is a majority, says John Knox.

DEVOURING CAPCITY OF INTEREST.

The following tables, with explanations, were compiled by Edward Kellogg:

Two mechanics, just come of age, are desirous of accumulating large fortunes. They are good workmen, and each is able to earn a dol-

lar a day over and above his expenses. Every six months they loan the money thus earned at 7 per cent. interest, the interest payable half yearly. They set their affections upon being rich, and therefore do not burden themselves with a house and family. These men earn an average of a dollar a day beside their expenses, 300 days in each year, during forty years and four months. Their age is then sixty-one years and four months. Each earns by labor $300 per year for forty years, or, for the whole period, $12,100—together, $24,200. The interest on their earnings, loaned half yearly, for a period of forty years and four months, accumulates an amount which will be seen by reference to the following table. Interest at 7 per cent. per annum, paid and reloaned half yearly, accumulates a sum equal to the principal in ten years and one month.

1st half year they earn by their labor...	$300 00
6 months' interest at 7 per cent.....	10 50
	310 50
2nd half year's labor.....	300 00
	610 50
6 months' interest.....	21 37
	631 87
3d half year's labor.....	300 00
	931 87
6 months' interest.....	32 61
	964 48
4th half year's labor.....	300 00
	1,264 48
6 month's interest...	44 26
	1,308 74
5th half year's labor.....	300 00
	1,608 74
6 months' interest...	56 30
	1,665 04
6th half year's labor.....	300 00

Amount brought up... ...	$1,965 04
6 months' interest.....	68 78
	2,033 82
7th half year's labor.....	300 00
	2,333 82
6 months' interest..... .	81 68
	2,415 50
8th half year's labor.....	300 00
	2,715 50
6 months' interest...	95 04
	2,810 54
9th half year's labor	300 00
	3,110 54
6 months' interest..... ...	108 87
	3,219 41
10th half year's labor...	300 00
	3,519 41
6 months' interest.....	123 18
	3,642 59
11th half year's labor..... .	300 00
	3,942 59

Amount brought up	$ 3,942 59	Amount brought up	$ 6,291 29
6 month's interest	137 99	6 months' interest	220 20
	4,080 58		6,511 49
12th half year's labor	300 00	17th half year's labor	300 00
	4,380 58		6,811 49
6 months' interest	153 32	6 months' interest	238 40
	4,533 90		7.049 89
13th half year's labor	300 00	18th half year's labor	300 00
	4,833 90		7,349 89
6 months' interest	169 18	6 months' interest	257 25
	5,003 08		7,607 14
14th half year's labor	300 00	19th half year's labor	300 00
	5,303 08		7,807 14
6 months' interest	185 61	6 months' interest	276 75
	5,438 69		8,183 89
15th half year's labor	300 00	20th half year's labor	300 00
	5,788 69		8,483 89
6 months' interest	202 60	6 months' interest	49 49
	5,991 29		8,533 38
16th half year's labor	300 00	Add one month's labor	50 00
	6,291 29		$8,583 38

In the first ten years and one month, the two men earn by their labor	$ 6,050 00
Interest thereon during this period	2,533 38
	8,583 38
In the 2d ten years and one month, the interest on this sum equals the principal	8,583 28
	17,166 76
2d 10 years and 1 month's labor, and interest thereon	8,583 38
	25,750 14
3d interest	25,750 14
	51.500 28
3d labor and interest thereon	8,583 38
	60,083 66
4th interest	60,083 66
	120,167 32
4th labor and inteiest thereon	8,583 38
	128,750 70
In 40 years and 4 months the men earn by their labor	24,200 00
Remainder accumulated by interest	$104,550 70

The interest on the sum ($24,200) earned by their labor is $104,550.70—over four and a quarter times more than they have earned by their labor. Suppose the two men to live twenty years and two months longer—that is,

to the age of eighty one years and six months —and continue to loan their money. During this period it would double twice.

Thus	$128.750 70
10 years and 1 month's interest	128,750 70
	257.501,40
2d 10 years and 1 month's interest	257,501 40
Total accumu ation in 60 years and 6 months	$515,002 80
The two men do not labor during the last 20 years and 2 months, and expend for their living during that period	15,002 80
	500,000 00
In 40 years and 4 months they earn by their labor $24,200, and live 20 years and 2 months on their money without labor.	
Subtract money earned by labor	24,200 00
Remainder accumulated by interest on $24.200	$475,800 00

Every dollar of the $475,800 is earned by the labor of others, and given to the two men as the legal interest upon $24,200. These men live laboriously, and work for a very moderate compensation. They take only the legal rate of interest, and do not demand the principal of the money as long as the interest is paid. Neither do they enter into any speculations. It is therefore said that labor earns their large fortunes. Cases similar to this are often brought to prove that an industrious man may, by his labor, accumulate a large property. That this conclusion is erroneous, is manifest from the foregoing table, by which it appears that more than nineteen out of twenty parts of the large fortunes of these men are earned by others, and paid to them to satisfy the legal interest on their loans of money.

Now let us suppose the interest on money to be 2 per cent., and, with this difference only, these two men to be placed in the same circumstances in which they have already been described. They earn over and above their ex-

penses a dollar a day, 300 days in each year, during a period of forty years and four months. They loan their earnings at the legal rate of interest (2 per cent.), and collect and reloan the interest half yearly.

1st half year's labor. .. $	300 00
6 months' interest at 2 per cent	3 00
	303 00
2d half year's labor	300 00
	603 00
6 months' interest	6 03
	609 03
3d half year's labor	300 00
	909 03
6 months' interest. ..	9 09
	918 12
4th half year's labor	300 00
	1.218 12
6 months' interest.	12 18
	1,230 30
5th half year's labor	300 00
	1,530 30
6 months' interest.	15 30
	1 545 60
6th half year's labor.... ...	300 00
	1,845 60
6 months' interest	18 46
	1,864 06
7th half year's labor	300 00
	2,164 06
6 months' interest	21 64
	2,185 70
8th half year's labor.	300 00
	2,485 70
6 months' interest	24 86
	2,510 56
9th half year's labor	300 00
	2,810 56
6 months' interest	28 11
	2,838 67
10th half year's labor	300 00
	1,138 67
6 month's interest	31 39
	3,170 06

Amount brought up ..... $	3,170 06
11th half year's labor..... .	300 00
	3,470 06
6 months' interest	34 70
	3,504 76
12th half year's labor.....	300 00
	3,804 76
6 months' interest	38 05
	3,842 81
13th half year's labor..... .	300 00
	4,142 81
6 months, interest..... ...	41 43
	4,184 24
14th half year's labor. . ..	200 00
	4,484 24
6 months' interest.....	44 84
	4,529 08
15th half year,s labor.....	300 00
	4,829 08
6 months, interest...	48 29
	4,877 37
16th half year,s labor.....	300 00
	5,177 27
6 months, interest..... ..	51 77
	5,229 14
17th half year,s labor.....	300 00
	5,529 14
6 months' interest	55 29
	5,584 43
18th half year's labor	300 00
	5,884 43
6 months' interest.....	58 84
	5,943 27
19th half year's labor.....	300 00
	6,243 27
6 months' interest.....	62 48
	6,305 70
20th half year's labor.....	300 00
	6.605 70
Add 1 month's interest....	11 06

Amount brought up...	$ 6,616 76	Amount brought up	$ 18,107 42
Add 1 month's labor.....	50 00	3d 10 years and 1 month's labor and interest	6,666 76
	6,666 76		24,774 18
Add 10years and 1 month's interest at 2 per cent....	1,481 55	10 years and 1 month's interest	5,505 88
	8,148 31		30,280 06
2d 10 years and 1 month's labor and interest.....	6,666 76	4th 10 years and 1 month's labor and interest	6,666 76
	14,815 07		
10 years and 1 month's interest	3,292 35		$36,946 82

Add the interest at 2 per cent. for twenty years and two months longer, until the men reach the age of eighty-one years and six months.

1st ten years and one month's interest.....	8,210 69
	45,157 51
2d ten years and one month's interest	10,035 35
	$55,192 86
In forty years and four months the two men earn by their labor	$24,200 00
The interest upon this sum for a period of sixty years and six months, even at 2 per cent., amounts to.....	30,992 00
	$55,192 00

This is $6,790 more than they earn by their labor.

When it is considered that this interest or rent is paid for the mere use of money or of capital, every reflecting honest mind must be convinced that two per cent. is a higher rate of interest than a people can afford to pay. It is surely most unreasonable for the laws to compel producers to pay for the use of property which a man may acquire by forty or fifty years' labor, twice or thrice the sum of the property so earned. The thing produced is more highly esteemed than the power that produces it. If an interest of two per cent. upon a well regulated currency would accumulate the property of a nation in the possession of a few, can it be considered strange that the rates of three, four, five, six and seven per cent., and even higher rates, which are exacted in different countries, should have concentrated property into so few

hands? The only wonder is that producers have continued to live under this oppression.

A rate of interest of even two per cent. per annum, would put it out of the power of the people to fulfill their contracts. The establishment of this rate of interest would be equivalent to the passing of a law, compelling the laboring classes to double the capital of a nation, in favor of capitalists once in thirty-four and a half years, besides producing their own support. Suppose a foreign nation owned all the real and personal estate in this nation, and a fair estimate were made of the value of all; and then our people were legally obliged to pay two per cent. yearly upon its valuation, besides maintaining themselves, would not a tribute of tax like this keep us forever in poverty? Our laws enforce much higher rates of interest on capital, which are less oppressive to the great body of our producers, because they are paid to a few capitalists in our own land instead of to foreigners.

It may be objected that some of the illustrations of the accumulative power of interest are based on so long periods as to present exagerated results; but it must be bourne in mind that interest, and rents, at too high rates are continually accruing to the capital of nations, and are producing their evil effects upon the people whether the loans be for longer or shorter periods.

It may be supposed that if interest were diminished to one per cent., property and labor would rise in the same proportion, and therefore, the producing classes would receive no benefit from the reduction. But whether prop-

erty should rise, or fall, or maintain its present price, producers would have the same relative advantage; their gain would be from the lessened percentage on capital. If a man borrowed a hudred dollars for a year, he would pay but one dollar for the use of one hundred, instead of paying seven dollars. If he hired a hundred acres of land, he would have to earn only one acre to pay for the use of one hundred, instead of being obliged to earn seven to pay for their use; for the per centage on money governs the rent of land. This principle of the adequate reward of labor, by the decrease of the interest on money, although property and labor in consequence should rise in price, will be illustrated in the following table. The price of labor is calculated at six dollars per day, and the interest on money at one per cent. per annum. The men earn their money, nnd loan it as in the former cases.

1st 6 months' labor	$1,800 00
6 months' interest at 1 per cent	9 00
	1,800 00
2d half year's labor..... ..	1.800 00
	3.609 00
6 months' interest....	18 04
	3,627 04
3d half year's labor.....	1,800 00
	5,327 04
6 months' interest.....	27 14
	5,454 18
4th half year's labor.....	1,800 00
	7,254 18
6 months' interest....	36 27
	7,290 45
5th half year's labor.... ...	1,800 00
	9,090 45
6 months' interest.....	45 45
	9,135 90

Amount brought up.... ..	$9,135 90
6th half year's labor.....	1,800 00
	10.835 90
6 months' interest.....	54 68
	10,990 58
7th half year's labor .. .	1,800 00
	12,790 58
6 months' interest.....	63 95
	12,854 53
8th half year's labor.... ..	1,800 00
	14,654 53
6 months' interest.....	73 27
	14,727 80
9th half year's labor	1,800 00
	16,527 80
6 months' interest	82 64
	16,610 44
10th half year's labor.....	1,800 00
	18,410 44
6 months' interest..... ..	92 05

Amount brought up	$18,502 59
11th half year's labor	1,800 00
	20,302 59
6 months' interest	101 51
	20,404 10
12th half year's labor	1,800 00
	22,204 10
6 months' interest	111 02
	22,315 12
13th half year's labor	1,800 00
	24,115 12
6 months' interest	120 58
	24,235 70
14th half year's labor	1,800 00
	26,305 70
6 months' interest	130 18
	26,165 88
15th half year's labor	1,800 00
	27,965 88
6 months' interest	139 88
	28,105 76
16th half year's labor	1,800 00

Amount brought up	$33,814 56
6 months' interest	169 97
	25,983 64
17th half year's labor	1,800 00
	31,855 29
6 months' interest	159 28
	32,014 57
18th half year's labor	1,800 00
	33,814 57
6 months' interest	178 92
	35,962 56
19th half year's labor	1,800 00
	35,783 64
6 months' interest	178 92
	35,962 56
20th half year's labor	1,800 00
	37,762 56
1 month's interest	31 47
	37,794 03
1 month's labor	300 00
	$38,094 03

10 years and 1 month's labor and interest	$38,094 03
2d 10 years and 1 month's interest	4,030 44
	42,124 47
10 years and 1 month's labor and interest	38,094 03
	80,218 50
3d 10 years and 1 month's interest	8,487 24
	88,705 74
10 years and 1 month's labor and interest	38,094 03
	126,799 77
4th 10 years and 1 month's interest	13,415 34
	140,215 11
10 years and 1 month's labor and interest	38,094 03
	178,309 14
In 40 years and 4 months the two men earn at $6 per day	$145,200 00
Interest thereon for 40 years and 4 months at 1 per cent.	33,109 14
	178,300 14
Let the interest on $78,309.14 accumulate 20 years and 2 months, until the men arrive at the age of 81 years and 6 months. Interest on $178,309.14 for 10 years at 1 per cent	18,865 02
	197,174 16
2d 10 years' interest	20,854 80
	218,028 96
They cease to labor at the age of 16 years and 4 months and expend during 20 years and 2 months, six times more than when labor was at $1 per day. They expend six times $14,995. Deduct	89,970 00
	$128,058 96

With interest at seven per cent and labor at $1 per day, the two men leave to their heirs $500,000; while with interest at one per cent., and labor at $6 per day, they leave to their heirs $128,058, only a fraction over one-fourth as much as in the former case. The interest on $500,000, at seven per cent., would be $35,000 annually. It would take the labor of one man, at $1 per day one hundred and sixteen years to pay the interest for a year. The interest on $128,058, at one per cent., would be $1,280. The labor of one man for two hundred and thirteen days, at $6 per day, would pay the interest for a year.

BANKS.

The amount of specie owned by the banks, and the interest paid by the people on bank loans, before the civil war:

The chartered banks profess to transact their business entirely on a specie basis. If, to show the actual amount of their specie, we take that of the banks of Connecticut, which have been conducted with as much safety to the public, and credit to themselves, as those of any other State in the Union, and far more than the average, it will be not only a fair but a favorable criterion of the specie capital of the banks of other States. The following table, extracted from the "Merchant's Magazine," vol. xvii., page 209, is an abstract of the Commissioner's Report for eleven years, from 1837 to 1847 in-

clusive ; to which is added from the same work, vol. xxii., page 320, the Commissioner's Report for the year 1849. Thus we have the following statement of the banks during twelve years.

Year	Capital.	Circulation.	Total Liabilies	Specie.	Loans and discounts.
1837	$8,744,697 50	$3,998,325 30	$15,715,964 59	$415,386 10	$13,246,495 08
1838	8,754,467 50	1,920,552 45	12,302,613 11	535,447 86	9,760,286 80
1839	8,832,223 00	3,087,815 45	14,942,779 31	502,180 15	12,286,946 97
1840	8,878,245 00	2,320,589 95	12,950,572 40	989,032 52	10 418,630 87
1841	8,873,927 50	2,784,721 45	13,866,373 45	454,298 61	10,944,673 36
1842	8,876,317 57	2,555,638 33	13,465,052 32	471,238 08	10,683,412 37
1843	8,580,393 50	5,379,947 02	12,914,124 66	438,752 92	9,798,392 27
1844	8,292 238 00	3,490,903 06	14,572,681 32	454,430 30	10,842,955 35
1845	8,359,748 00	4,102,444 00	15,243,235 79	453,658 79	12,477,196 06
1846	8,475,630 00	3,565,847 06	15,882,685 25	481,367 09	13,032,600 78
1847	8,675 742 00	4,437,631 06	15,784,782 04	462,165 52	12,781,857 43
	95,273,623 57	38,549,475 13	157,550,872 44	5,168,657 95	126,292,888 33
1849	8,985,917 00	4 511,571 00		575,676 00	13,740,591 00
	$104,259,546 57			$5,744,633 95	$140,033,489 33

Average Capital	$ 8,688,295 55
Average Liabilies	13,129,230 37
Average Specie	478,719 70
Average Loans and Discounts	11,669,457 44

By the foregoing table it will be seen that the average amount of the specie held by the banks in the State of Conneticut, for the twelve years, was $478,719, while the average amount of their loans to the public, during that period, was $11,669,457—more than twenty-four and one third times as much money as the banks had specie. The annual interest on $11,669,457 was $700,167. If they could have loaned only their specie, the interest would have amounted to but $28,723. The banks gained from the public annually, $671,444 above the interest on their specie ; and, in twelve years $8,057,328. They collected this interest in advance, and made their dividends half yearly to their stockholders ; therefore, it is proper to compound this interest half yearly, which would swell their gains to nearly $12,000,000, that is to say, $1,-

000,000 interest annually. These were actual gains, as much realized by these banks as if they had produced and sold annually $700,167 worth of agricultural products.

These banks were chartered with a professed specie capital, averaging for the the twelve years, $8,679,962; while the average of the specie actually held by them was less than one-eighteenth part of this sum. How was this excess of capital above the average $478,719 in specie made up, and was it furnished by the stockholders or by the public? The specie held by these banks, as we have said, did not constitute one eighteeth part of their professed capital; hence there must have been other capital to make up the seventeen parts we find wanting, otherwise their bank-notes could not have been safe; for one thousand dollars' worth of land is as good security for the payment of eighteen thousand dollars in money, as one thousand in specie for the payment of eighteen thousand dollars in bank-notes. But the banks instead of eighteen lent over twenty-four dollars for each dollar in specie, so that the specie held by the banks was but a fraction over four per cent. of their loans. The specie was, then, a very small item in the security of the bank-notes, and was not essential to their safety. If the banks in other States have, in proportion to their loans, double the specie owned by the Conneticut banks, it is no evidence that they are more safe, because their safety depends upon four or eight per cent. of specie. No bank-notes can be safe money unless secured for their full amount.

Let us see how the specie capital of banks is generally made up. Suppose one bank to be chartered with a specie capital of $500,000, all paid in, and to lend $750,000 for approved indorsed notes. A second bank is likewise chartered with a capital of $500,000; to make up which, $400,000 of the notes of the first bank and $100,000 in specie, also drawn from it, are paid in. The notes of the first and second banks, together with a small sum in specie, form the capital of a third; and thus bank after bank is formed, say to the number of eighteen, each with a professed specie capital; while, in reality, all of them together own only $500,000, in specie. How is this excess over the $500,000 secured? The loans of the first bank for $500,000 were secured by the same sum in specie; but when it had lent $250,000 more, the excess was secured by the indorsed notes offered by the people for discount. When the second bank had discounted $750,000, the two banks had under discount a million and a half of dollars, one million of which was secured by indorsed notes, and but half a million by specie. A third, fourth, and finally eighteen banks having discounted $750,000 each of indorsed notes, the aggregate amount would be $13,500,000, of which $500,000 would be secured by specie, and the sole security for $13,000,000 would be the indorsed notes held by the banks against the public. Some of these discounted indorsed notes might be against stockholders in the banks; but all of them, whether against stockholders or others, are secured by the property of their drawers and indorsers, and

not by the capital of the banks. If thirteen out out of thirteen and a half millions of dollars, are made safe for the public use by these indorsed notes, evidently the remaining half million could be made safe in the same manner; and we could thus dispense with specie altogether. If ninety-six per cent. of the money is now secured by indorsed promissory notes, certainly the other four per cent. can be secured by similar means.

The people furnish the security for the bank-notes, and pay the interest, which is the source of all the gains of the banks. R. and S, are men of property. R. draws his note at six months for $10,000, gets S. to indorse it, and then has it discounted at bank. If interest be at seven per cent., R. will receive only $9,650 in bank-notes, and at the maturity of the note must pay $10,000 to take it up: the bank thus gains $350 as interest or rent of the bank-notes for six months. Under no circumstances would the bank discount the note unless it were deemed perfect security for the return of the money and the payment of the interest. R.'s note, indorsed by S., and held by the bank, is secured by the property of these men; and the bank-notes secured by the indorsed notes are also secured by the same property of R. and S. If the bank-notes circulate for six months, R.'s indorsed note also secures to the bank the return of $350 more than it gave for the note.

A similar illustration may be made on a more extended scale, say on $5,000,000; about the sum kept under discount by some of the larger banks in New York. Suppose a bank to dis-

count notes, drawn and indorsed by various individuals in good credit, for $5,000,000 having (to simplify the process, and bring the gains under one item) twelve months to run. It would pay to these individuals $4,650,000 in bank-notes : and the $350,000 deducted as discount would be clear gain, less the labor to make and exchange the bank-notes. If the public need the $4,650,000 to meet their business obligations for the year, the money will continue to circulate, and the bank will not be called upon to redeem it, during that period. At the close of the year, when the indorsed notes become due, if the drawers should collect every dollar of the bank-notes issued $35,000 would still be wanting to pay the bank the indorsed notes for $5,000,000 ; and the people would be dependent on the bank for a further discount of notes to obtain the money due as the year's interest. If one bank furnishes all the money of the nation, the people would be dependent on that one for money to fulfil all their obligations. Increase the number of banks to a thousand, and the indorsed notes in proportion, and the transactions will be more numerous and appear more complicated, as they actually are ; but it will not alter in the least the principles upon which the banks gain the interest out of the earnings of the public, while the public furnishes all the security necessary to make the bank-notes safe to circulate as money.

The people furnish double security to make the bank-notes safe that they give to each other in the ordinary purchase and sale of products.

The farmer sells his produce to the merchant or miller on credit; the miller sells his flour, the wool-grower his wool, and the manufacturer his goods, mostly on two, four, six, eight, ten and twelve month's credit to city merchants, who re-sell them on like credits to other city or country merchants, and these dispose of them chiefly on credit, to farmers, mechanics and other consumers. Farmers, mechanics and merchants, in ordinary good credit, can buy goods on their own responsibility; and their purchases are generally limited only by their own discretion. But they cannot take book accounts to the banks, and get bank-notes in exchange on the responsibility of the man who owes the money. Notes offered for discount must have only a certain time to run, must be drawn by men known to the directors to be responsible, and indorsed by one or two others in equally good credit. Thus the people do give at least double the security to make the bank-notes safe to circulate as money that they do to secure themselves against loss in the sale of the products of their own labor. Yet they pay to the banks five or six times more than a fair equivalent for the material and labor to make and exchange the bank-note for the indorsed notes; and this is a total loss to the producing classes, and a clear gain to the banks.

We will now estimate the proportion of capital stock furnished in specie by the stockholders of the banks in the State of New York, and the proportion furnished by the balancing power of paper against paper. The following table, taken from the State Register, shows

how much of the State currency, in 1844 and 1845, was based upon specie, and how much was based upon paper notes :

	Feb. 1, 1844.	May 1, 1874	August 1, 1874.	Nov. 1, 1874	Feb. 1, 1875.
Capital	$43,649,887	$43,462.311	$43,443,005	$43,618,607	$43,674,146
Circulation.	16,335.401	18,365,081	18,091 324	20,152,219	18,513,402
Canal Fund.	1.483,843	1.506,167	1.210,794	1,534,553	1,607,572
Deposits....	29.026,413	30.742,289	89,757,112	30,391,622	25,976.246
Due Banks... . .	15,710,554	16,457,494	16.102.922	14,431,103	11,501,102
Loans and Discounts	$70,025,734	$74.527,858	$75.546,592	$77,347.718	$70,888,578
Stocks and promissory notes	11,052,458	10,362,330	10.648,211	10.773,678	10,244,043
Specie....	20,086, 42	9,455.161	10.181,974	8,968,092	6,893.236
Cash Items	4.502,479	5.999,952	4,916.862	6,047,528	4,839,886
Bank-notes....	2,155.172	3,148,421	2,511,316	2.868.467	2,387.508
Due from Banks.....	10.267,207	8,817,279	8,859.328	8,767,513	7,684.308

From the foregoing table, it will be perceived that the banks were indebted at the above period to the amount of from $101,272,468, up to $110,128,104. The average indebtedness, including the refunding of the capital stock to the stock-holders, was $106,931,004. The average amount of their specie at the different periods as above, was $9,119,001. Deduct the specie from the indebtedness—*i. e.*, $9,119,001 from $106.931,004—and we have left $97,812,000, which sum must have been cancelled by paper. Our banks have specie enough to redeem only about one-fifth part of their capital. The balance of their capital stock, the redemption of the bank-notes in circulation, and the payment of the deposits, are secured by the indorsed notes of the people, binding the property of the drawers and indorsers. Their property as much secures the bank-notes, as it does their own notes. The bank-notes are representatives of the property of the people, and not representatives of the property of the banks. Not a single dollar of the paper issued

over and above the actual amount of specie, is secured by their capital stock, because, if none of these indorsed notes and bonds of the State were ever paid, not a single dollar of the indebtedness of the banks, either for bank-notes or deposits, above their actual specie would ever be paid. The $97.,812,003 would be a total loss to the holders of the bank-notes, to the depositors, and to the stock-holders.

The interest collected on the indorsed notes and State bonds supports the banks, and pays all their extravagant expenditures in granite buildings, salaries of officers, etc. They can pay their presidents and cashiers from $3,000 to $5,000 each, and other expenses, house-rent, etc., in proportion, to the amount of $40,000 or $50,000 yearly. They can also pay to the stock-holders from three to five, six or seven per cent. in dividends every six months. The banks under legislative authority make the public furnish the capital and then pay interest on this capital. But although the industry of the people supports the whole, they have no voice in the management. The directors in the banks can at any time call upon them to pay off their notes and cancel the bank-notes; and if they fail, they are blamed for over-production and over-trading. When the banks contract their loans rapidly, and distress the people, the directors are said to be prudent and judicious managers. Yet if the people should demand specie, the banks could not pay it, unless they could collect it out of the indorsed notes of the people. But these indorsed notes were never founded upon specie, and could not be paid in

it, because the drawing and indorsing of the notes by the people, and the engraving of the bank-notes by the banks, and the exchange of the bank-notes for the indorsed notes, do not create gold and silver coins to pay either the bank-notes or the indorsed notes. There has never been a time when the banks could have paid specie for a week, for their average deposits are more than three times their whole amount of specie.

The table shows that the average amount of the capital of the banks in the State of New York, during the period mentioned, was $43,569,591, and their average indebtedness was $106,931,004. The difference of these two sums is $74,361,413. The annual interest upon $73,361,413, at seven per cent., was $4,445,333, which the people of the State paid to the stockholders and officers of the banks for furnishing bank-notes above the amount of their professed specie capital. The people wrote their own notes, had them indorsed, and took them to the banks to be discounted. The banks engraved their bank-notes, and gave them in exchange for the indorsed notes. For engraving these notes and making these exchanges, the people of the State paid to the banks annually $4,535,333, or as much as the farmers of the State receive for four millions four hundred and thirty-five thousand three hundred and thirty-three bushels of wheat, at one dollar per bushel. The labor of producing such an amount of wheat was great; that of the bank-notes was small, yet the interest paid on these bank-notes would have bought this quantity of wheat. At

the end of the year the people of the State returned all the bank-notes to the banks, together with the value of this large amount of wheat to pay the year's interest. The same amount of interest accrued every year, and called for the same amount of their products. They sold their products in market, and paid the interest to the banks with the proceeds of the sales, the same to them as if they had carried their wheat and products directly to the banks to pay the interest. If the entire capital of the banks had been specie, the people would have paid the same amount for the use of the bank-notes which would have been issued over and above the specie.

The interest yearly paid for the use of $63,361,413, in bank-notes, was a legal equivalent for the four millions four hundred and thirty-five thousand three hundred and thirty-three bushels of wheat yearly raised upon a certain quantity of land; and the legal value of the $63,351,413, in bank-notes, was equal to the actual value of the land and labor necessary to produce the wheat. The power of the bank-notes was an extra balance against these products and the land upon which they were produced. If the quantity of money was at any time diminished, and the rate of interest increased, a larger amount of products was required to balance the smaller amount of money, and a larger amount of products to balance the interest on the smaller amount of money. Still this money must have been used to balance products, for it was the only public representative of value, and must have been employed

as a substitute for a tender, in payment of debts. The promise of it does not pay specie, nor does it alter the monopolizing power of the interest on the money over products.

If our bank-notes are good for the purchase of property by the people, certainly they ought to be equally good for the purchase of property by the banks. Let us reverse the relative positions of the banks and the people. Suppose instead of lending their money to the people to buy property, the banks should buy property with their bank-notes, and let it out to the people. This would put the bank-notes into circulation, and the banks would be the landlords of the property, instead of being the owners and lenders of the money. Let the people then call upon the banks for the redemption of the bank-notes in specie, and in default of payment sue them ; and if they wish to borrow bank-notes to save their property from sheriff's sale charge them one, two, or three per cent. a month for the use of the bank-notes. Let the banks try to rent their property so as to make the rents pay these rates of interest. This would only place the stockholders in a position similar to that in which they now often, though indirectly, place the people. It is evident that it would be impossible for them to redeem their bank-notes in specie, or to redeem them in any way except by selling their property and taking these bank-notes in payment, as the people now give their notes to the banks and pay the discount, and when their notes become due, collect these bank-notes together, and take them to the

banks to redeem their indorsed notes. If the banks should buy the property with their bank-notes, and their friends should guarantee the the property worth the price paid, the property and the guarantee would secure the bank-notes. It would only place the banks under the necessity of cultivating their property, and selling the products to pay the interest. It would be as possible to redeem the bank-notes with specie, under the supposed circumstances, as it now is. If the banks were called upon to redeem them now, they would crowd the people, and sell their property, and in the supposed circumstances, the people would crowd the banks, and sell their property. In both cases the debts must be cancelled by offsetting the property against them, for they could not be redeemed with specie.

It is perfectly obvious that our legislative bodies have founded our banking system on false pretences—upon promises the banks do not even expect to fulfil. The only reason why the banks can exist upon such a basis is, that the people do not demand the specie for their notes and deposits. The government enacts a law binding all debtors to make their payments in specie, when it is perfectly well known that specie does not exist in sufficient quantities to enable them to fulfil the requirement. More than eleven-twelfths of the debts between the banks and the people are contracted with a pa per balance, and have no referencs to specie. Of course, the only means of paying them is by balancing one paper note with another. If the banks, or the people, or the government,

should in every case enact what the laws require, it would be impossible to meet the demand. If the three should exact specie in payment of their obligations, it would inevitably bankrupt them all, and almost certainly cause starvation in the midst of abundance, if not civil war. If the governments of the States as well as the General Government should refuse to take bank-notes in collecting and disbursing their revenues, probably the people could not pay their duties and taxes. The necessary withdrawal of specie to meet these engagements would at once cause the banks throughout the Union to suspend specie payments. The need of money would then compel the people to petition the legislatures of their respective States to sanction this suspension, and allow the banks to continue to discount without paying specie on demand. They would, however, still be allowed to charge interest upon all of the indorsed notes of the people received in exchange for the bank-notes, which would then be avowedly destitute of any basis of specie.

Can anything be more directly opposed to every principle of justice, than laws requiring the performance of impossibilities? Laws which, if the people should attempt to execute them, instead of promoting peace and happiness, would cause the greatest calamities that could possibly befall a nation. It is essential to good government that the interest and welfare of the people should require the execution of its laws, and when their violation becomes necessary to the public good, it is

something radically wrong in the government itself. A government should never allow anything to pass as a substitute for money; the tender itself should be equal in amount to the wants of business. The law making gold and silver the only tender in payment of debts is well adapted to build up and sustain monarchical governments, because it most infallibly accumulates property in the hands of a few, constituting aristocracies, which are essential to this form of government; but the same reason that qualifies it so admirably for this purpose, renders it incompatible with a government having for its sole object the welfare and happiness of the people.

HOW INTEREST ACCUMULATES.

Twenty-four years ago a man by the name of Walker, in California, borrowed $1,850, and agreed to pay 3 per cent. a month compound interest for it, the note being secured by a mortgage on land in Santa Clara county. Subsequently Walker went to Mexico, before the note fell due, without paying any interest. On his return, a short time since, suit was brought to recover the amount, according to agreement. The court at San Francisco rendered a judgment for $9,492,908, for the use of the $1,850 twenty-four years. It is well that Walker got a decision now, for if it had continued 24 years longer it would have amounted to some over two billions, four hundred millions of dollars,

about the cost of our civil war. When labor cannot bear, on an average, even 2 per cent, there need be no wonder we have a "smash-up" among business-men every ten years.

RAILROADS NO MONOPOLY.

Railroad companies are regarded as monopolists by many. This is an erroneous impression. Railroads have increased our velocity in traveling from 6 to 25 miles an hour, at half the expense, and are safer than the old stage coach. They have in a short time exerted an almost miraculous power in developing our Western States, and to-day are affording transportation at reasonable rates in most parts of the civilzed world. Railroads cost money. Usually bonds have been issued, drawing from 8 to 10 per cent. interest (interest is the trouble,) put upon the market and hypothecated. The interest and loss on hypothecation to railroad companies the people are obliged to pay in tariffs—production or labor must bear all shrinkages.

To-day the indebtedness of railroad companies in the United States is $2,489,000,000. If the profits on money were in harmony with the average profit on labor, viz., two and one-half per cent., $125,000,000 would be saved for the people annually. Accumulating interest by the money power, and failure of railroad companies to pay, has been the cause of the sale of some road every month in the year. The feeble companies have been driven to the wall—sold out

—the best find "hard sledding." If the railroad companies economize sufficiently to pay all their debts, they are then said to be monopolies. Strikes then ensue. The strikers fail to comprehend the situation. They strike the free horse hard at work for his master, while the fat, lazy horses, connected with the road by first mortgage bonds, that hold back and retard industry, are unnoticed. It costs an immense amount to keep up rolling stock and the multiplicity of expenses. A prominent railroad official said to me that, "if we take into account the replacement of track, cars and many bridges every ten years, railroads in the United States do not pay more than two and one half per cent." Railroad companies promptly pay their help all they are able to. When this fact is understood, employees will be the friends, instead of enemies, of the roads.

If the Grange party had struck at the root, instead of haggling at the branches, it would have been a power in our land to-day. The interest of railroad companies and the people are identical, and they should work in harmony for the interests of both.

Remember, interest on money is the Devil going about seeking whom he may devour. Railroad companies, manufacturers, merchants and producers, indeed, all doing business on borrowed capital, are in a vice which is squeezing the life out of them in the payment of ungodly interest on money.

Vanderbilt and a few others may have watered railroad stocks and received interest on false representations, but as a whole, railroads

in this country, like individuals in debt, have been obliged to economize in order to pay pressing claims. While we do not apologize for said corporations, we do believe that when the truth shall be understood, there will be no more "strikes" on railroads. When employees of manufactuers shall understand that the money power crowding their employers to the wall, is the cause of a reduction of wages, there will then be sympathy, charity and love, instead of hatred and "strikes." The great dragon of this world is the money power, controlled by a few selfish indivuals. All producers should join hands, saw off his horns, cut off his claws, knock out his teeth; then, and not until then, will labor possess and enjoy its normal condition.

THE FAT OX.

Interest takes the fat, lean meat and hide of the stall fed ox, leaving the gristle, horns, hoofs and tail for the man who reared and fattened the animal.

REBUILT CHICAGO.

Rebuilt Chicago is to-day on its knees begging of the Money King of the East to take its buildings, lands and labor to release her from obligation of principal and interest. But, no! this bloated and feelingless monarch of money

says: "your lots and marble blocks that cost $100,000 or $125,000 will not pay our claim of $50,000. If it will not sell at auction for as much as our claim, we will bid it in and hold you our labor slaves until you pay the utmost farthing." Such is the accumulating power of interest at 10 per cent. semi-annually. Those splendid blocks are not the product of money but are the product of labor. Natural law declares that labor should command money, but the law has been reversed. Now money commands labor. The result is that a majority of those who rebuilt Chicago are bankrupt. Interest eats up surplus production; it devoureth another's substance; it has made a hell upon earth. They say now-a-days that there is no hell hereafter. If not, there ought to be one.

INDEBTEDNESS OF UNITED STATES.

Mr. Jones, United States Senator, in an official capacity, estimates the indebtedness of our country, public and private, as follows:

National	$ 2,000,000,000
States	390,000,000
Cities, towns and counties	850,000,000
Railroads	2,439,000,000
Canals	105,000,000
Banks, insurance, individuals, etc.	13,244,000,000
Total	$19,028,000,000

The interest on this sum at 7 per cent per annum will amount to $1,333,360,000. This will require the labor annually of 5,454,640 able-

bodied men, at $250 per year to pay the interest. Of course this does not include their livings, for all slaves must eat while they work for their masters. Labor in this country should be clothed in the habiliments of mourning. Is it any wonder that there is a dead-lock upon industry? Gracious God! "Is there no balm in Gilead; Is there no physician there?" Yes; the ballot-box can cure the financial ills of this republic. Iowa at its last election reduced the hard money majority twenty-five thousand, and will at the next election have a majority of 30,000 over the golden calf. If not, then the Lord hath not sworn by us.

SUICIDE.

In the "History of Merchants" we find that during forty years 99 out of every hundred failed in Boston, some of them three or four times. These failures were attributed, in a majority of cases, to fluctuation in the money market. Many of those unfortunate tradesmen became reckless, and went into the saloon business. Others turned out gamblers, while still others, being disheartened and depressed, committed suicide. In the same number of years 95 per cent. failed in Cincinnati, owing to the frequent derangments of the finances. Very many of these unfortunate merchants jumped into the Ohio river and were drowned. Others went into the liquor business or steamboating. In the last named city the statutes show that 32

per cent. of suicides in four years were caused by business troubles. Physicians at insane asylums inform us that a large proportion of the insane males were made so by the loss of property, caused, no doubt, by this infernal interest on money. Facts show that the "sting" of interest has made more men insane, intemperate and vicious than any other one thing.

SOLID MEN.

When Bunyan's pilgrim was on his way to Mount Zion, he passed a city, in the suburbs of which he met three solid men, Capitalist, Broker and Banker, who inquired of the young man where he was going. He replied: "I am going to the Celestial City." "So are we, by and by, but we are going first to a silver mine, where the ore is rich and plenty. Come, you look like an honest, enterprising young man, and go with us to the mine and get some of the good of this world, and enjoy life. The pilgrim was tempted, but had sufficient fortitude to coutinue the straight and narrow road that leads to Heaven. The three solid men went down in the silver mine and were never heard of afterward. Thus we have proof that "It is as hard for a rich man to enter into the Kingdom of Heaven as for a camel to go through the eye of a needle." Some of the wealthy make good use of their money; never oppress by taking usury, but we fear, by reading the the great good book, that a majority of the solid

men worship a god of gold, and when weighed in the balance will be found of "light weight," and wanting in every quality to enjoy a celestial life.

WARNING TO "STRIKERS."

Millions of good men in this nation sympathise with the oppressed, but who will not countenance the distruction of property. The distressed can bring this strong moral force to their aid, provided moral means (ballots, not bullets) are used, instead of physical force. When force is used to take or destroy the property of others, it will not only bring sure and just punishment upon the offending parties, but will put off the time of their relief. We warn all such *imprudent men* to desist from any illegal course. Don't study, plan or devise any course whereby property shall be distroyed, but study and labor to bring about a strong moral force at the ballot-box, which will secure just and equitable laws that will give industry an equal chance on the Columbian race-course. Strikers and communists, do right and you may depend upon it, a better day is coming.

MORTGAGES ON CHURCHES.

To turn over to the Lord a church edifice, upon which avarice has a mortgage, is not only unchristian but too mean for anyone professing

godliness. No church should be dedicated to God, while the virus of the serpent is biting each member thereof. The demoralizing influence of mortgages and interest unpon too many churches in our land is crushing out the true spirit of Christ. The tendency is to make christian people dishonest, as shown in a prayer, published in the *North Western Christian Advocate*, Nov. 6, as follows :

"O Lord, acccept our offering on this day, we pray thee. We have built thee a big house. It has cost one hundred thousand dollars ; that is about thirty thousand dollars in cash, and seventy thousand dollars in debts, mostly mortgage. To-day we dedicate both to thy use. But we would like to have thee take especial care of the mortgage, and not suffer it to torment, when it falls due, us who have so zealously labored to make it as large as possible. We realize, of course, that among ourselves we do not do business on that basis, accepting a gift of one dollar for the pleasure of paying two or three more to save the one. But then we feel that it is safe to ask thee to do that which is not safe for us to attempt. The thirty thousand dollars is all we could scrape together, unless we went without those new phætons, velvet carpers, etc., which we had to have, or let the wicked of this world surpass thy people in the parlor or on the pavement. But we would not like to have thee think us paupers. Most of us are making comfortable livings and something for steady investment ; and two dozen of us, by clubbing together, could easily raise the entire debt in a day. However, the blessings

of sacrifice in thy cause we could not monopolize, but share with such as may come later into the fold. Thus moved, we leave to them and the multitude present to-day the seventy thousand dollar opportunity to take stock in thy house. We shall endeavor to pay the interest on this debt until thou shalt persuade other men to pay the principal.

"Our wants in religion are greater than those of our fathers. They worshiped in much cheaper temples; but they were a simple folk, and easy led. We are a larger race of people; our minds are broader. And, therefore, greater temple splendor is needed to draw us from home on Sunday. Our fathers had no Sunday papers, few magazines, many couldn't read anyway, and few had any taste. We know the church-attending people of this city could have found room without this gorgeous structure. But then, some of the good brethren owned a number of lots in this neighborhood; also, the——church had a fine edifice, and we couldn't bear to be outdone by it; we preferred to make our frescoing a little the richest in town, and our spire a little the tallest, although we did have to put a mortgage under to lift it. We are proud of this pile of stone and timber. Indeed, pride has had a large hand in its architecture; the mortgage covers more pride than necessity. But it quickens us to see strangers look admiringly up to this structure and applaud it as 'a magnificent church; about the finest in the city; very, wealthy congregation and popular preacher; fashionable resort.' Such public notice is very gratifying to us, and we hope that thou, O Lord,

doth catch some of the drippings from our great glory."

"Now, Lord, we are going to press this dear congregation for subscriptions toward this church debt. We have got a large number of innocent ones in here, church members and folks of the world. True, their consent was not asked to the building of this church. It seldom is. Contractinig great debts belongs of right to the few. The multitude's opportunity is pay-day. Nothing shall cheat the poor man of a blessed privilege of contributing toward his house of worship by paying the debt his official board in its superior wisdom has contracted. We trust that the hearts of all may be moved to give liberally, and thus come up to thy help against the mighty mortgage we now dedicate to thee. We want the money of those men who would be ashamed to give less than others. Therefore it has been arranged that Brothers Jones and Smith and Perkins shall act as stool-pigeons at this time, to entrap men who would give but meanly if they gave only what they wanted to. The brethren named will start the good work of subscribing with $1,000 each on paper, though the right-hand cipher may succumb to wear and tear before collection day, but this day's object is to be attained in no other way. We don't exactly approve the trick, but we trust that thou wilt excuse the means in view of the end. We leave the matter in thy hands hopefully."

"TINKERING" THE FINANCES.

The Hard-Shells don't want the people to "tinker" with the finances: They of *divine* right can do all the "tinkering." The truth is, the people need exactly the opposite of what the money power wants. The Hard-Shells want contraction–the cause of wheat, corn, pork, and cotton selling now 20 per cent. lower than in 1860: the people need expansion. The Hard-Shells want a gold and silver basis, upon which so many banks have failed, and carried millions to their financial graves: the people need honest fiat money. The Hard-Shells want a few rascals to manipulate the currency: the people want honest Uncle Sam for Banker. The Hard-Shells want Exorbitant rates of interest, which are now crushing out the industries of the nation: the people want to pay Uncle Sam a reasonable rate of interest, that will benefit both borrower and lender. The Hard-Shells want to build up an aristocracy: the people want a financial system that will distribute property to whom it belongs. Satan is on the side of the Hard-Shells. God is on the side of the people. It is easy to determine which will triumph.

THE "LILIES."

The garments of the "lilies" of land, "who toil not, neither do they spin," are died in the innocent blood of labor It is said man is arbiter of his own fortune. It is impossible for

man to be the "arbiter of his own fortune" until we get a just and equitable monetary system. Men cannot do business without capital. Our laws are such, money cannot be obtained without ungodly interest. Business men might as well give up the ghost first as last.

HOW TO KILL SATAN.

If you want to kill the devil loan him money, on long time at 10 per cent. compound semi-annually, on a cast steel mortgage with usual conditions, to pay costs and lawyers' fees, and confess judgment in case of non-payment of interest, and his demise will only be matter of time. But there is one difficulty in the way. Money lenders will not now take his satanic majesty's security, consequently Old Beelzebub will continue for a season.

INTEREST DEATH TO OUR REPUBLIC.

Money at	2	per cent.	doubles	in	35	years.
Money at	3	"	"		23	"
Money at	4	"	"		17	"
Money at	5	"	"		14	"
Money at	6	"	"		11	"
Money at	7	"	"		10	"
Money at	8	"	"		9	"
Money at	9	"	"		8	"
Money at	10	"	"		7	"

Nineteen thousand million dollars at 6 per cent. interest anually is bleeding the American people. As the total wealth of the United States is but about thirty thousand million dollars, in 18 years Shylock will have received an amount equivalent to the whole value of our government. Fiat paper money is our only savior. With this money the people by hard labor may pay the interest. Without it our land will become a nation of paupers and slaves.

LIFE AN IRREPRESSIBLE CONFLICT.

From tables of life insurance companies it appears that 36 years is the average of human life in the United States. Each person, by judging of his own troubles and difficulties, can make a feeble estimate of the irrepressible conflict of life in our nation. Misery is antagonistic to happiness. To avoid misery should be the study of all. As all increase of substance to sustain life comes from labor, all either with hands or head should add their quota to the common stock of wealth. As money does not possess any accumulating power, government does an injury to itself by enacting laws which sanction the right of money to accumulate. It builds up an idle class of nobility whose only study is to rob labor of its superior production. Money is a tremendous power for good or evil. Statesmen, who can wipe away the tears of the oppressed, should understand that those who produce the money of the nation, have a na-

tural right to control that power. The people will probably soon demand that their servants in Congress stop "tinkering" the finances for the benefit of the money power, but that the government shall assume the banking interest of the nation. The great conflict of the house is the Money Power against the People.

GOLD AS A BASIS A FRAUD.

The institution of money possesses four qualities, viz., measurement of values, representation of values, exchange of values, and a reasonable accumulation of values, as a necessity. As expense attaches to a circulating medium, the nation should charge a reasonable rate of interest to sustain the government, and then distribute the profits to the people who by labor produce the increase. The four powers of money we shall probably discuss at length in another book. No national power inheres to mineral or paper to make them money, for they do not sustain life, as they only represent the value of human necessities. If mineral or paper represent the four qualities above named, law may declare it money, and it will be money It will pay all debts and purchase substances

The kind of material that possesses no intrinsic value, and is most convenient, the government should select, put its stamp upon it, and use it as money. If the material possesses intrinsic value, it is a commodity, and is subject to the laws of supply and demand, like all other

merchandise. If the material be leather, we cannot use what bears the government stamp to protect our feet; if it is wheat, we cannot eat it; if it is woolen cloth, we must substitute cotton, linen or something else with which to protect our bodies; if it be gold, so much thereof is taken from the natural channel of merchandise. Therefore, money in and of itself should not possess any intrinsic value, but should be fiat paper, and rest for security upon the soil, gold, silver and everything else intrinsic in the nation. This is the only natural and solid foundation upon which money can be permanently based. Nature never declared that gold should be money; if so it would have produced enough for the purposes of money. If used as money, nature has provided just enough to build up an aristocracy to the few, at the expense of the many.

The population of those countries that use gold alone is 180,000,000; those that use silver, 877,000,000; those that use both silver and gold, 133,000,000.

Jewett, a hard-shell author, says that the amount of gold coin in the world, in 1875, was $1,972,500,000; that of silver coin, $1,800,000,000. Total, $3,772,5000,000. The amount of paper money was $3,886,000,000. The excess of paper money was $113,500,000. This does not include drafts, checks, orders and immeasurable paper balances. Now, what is the money of the world? Paper money, based upon productive property that sustains life, is a reality. Money based upon a dead thing, that does not increase and does not possess any vi-

tal force or power of accumulation, is a fraud. If you borrow gold and pay interest thereon, you must give productive security (gold requires it) or security that comes from production. If government bonds are pledged, they are based upon the property of the nation ; if by endorsers, their soundness was derived from production, or Mother Earth. All that is sound comes from the soil, because it sustains life, the object of toil. The object of life is to faciliate the exchange of barter, also to represent the value of the same. Money based upon this source, the real value and wealth of the globe, rests upon the parent of all things intrinsic, natural security furnished by the Deity, on which the human race may base their paper medium of exchange. Hence, England, France and the United States have been obliged to issue paper money when in distress, based upon the credit of the nation. Gold, so far as answering the purposes of money, is a failure, for there is not enough of it to redeem the paper based upon it. The Bank of England was based upon gold or specie. It issued paper based upon coin ; some say that the Bank issued one hundred pounds to one in specie. We do not know, but suffice it to say that a run was made on the Bank, and on the 25th day of February, 1797, the Privy Council required the directors to forbear paying any cash until Parliament should direct ways and means. Parliament required the directors to continue the business of the Bank by issuing paper and to redeem said paper when it shall be convenient and necessary. The Bank suspended specie payment and issued the following circular:

"BANK OF ENGLAND, February 27, 1797.

In consequence of the order of His Majesty's privy council notified to the Bank last night, a copy is herewith annexed. The government and Deputy Governor and Directors of the Bank of England, think it their duty to inform the proprietors and stockholders, as well as the public at large, that the general concerns of the bank are in a most affluent and prosperous condition, and such as to preclude every doubt as to the security of its notes. The directors mean to continue their usual discounts for the accommodation of commercial interests, paying in bank notes, and the dividend warrants will be paid in the same way.

FRANCIS MARTIN, Secretary."

John Bull well knew how to assume a bold front of "affluence and prosperity" when he could not redeem his pledges. The bank suspended specie payment for 21 years. During that period it issued all the paper currency needed for the business of the country, and claimed that its paper was based upon coin, when in fact it was based upon the credit of the nation. Manufacturers were more prosperous during that 21 years than any fifty years before or after that period. Commerce took a tremendous stride; thousands and thousands were engaged in building ships, until England became mistress of the seas, which position she has since held and probably will hold until our government issues fiat money. Then the United States will become master of the waters of our globe. Now this is just what we want—the government to issue, upon the credit of the nation, all the paper needed for business purposes, loan the same on long time, the rates of interest not to exceed three per cent. This accomplished, our manufacturers can compete with any nation on the earth. Hav-

ing the raw material, cheap food, the best of machinery and skilled workmen, the United States could beat the world. Our ships would double their capacity in five years. Then will the United States become the commercial center of the world. Plenty of money, with low and uniform interest, our republic would soon be the most successful, the strongest and most desirable for a home of any, if not all other governments upon the earth. But we must stick to the text, gold and silver basis a fraud. We have bank commissioner's reports of nearly all the States before the civil war. From these reports it appears that the banks, on an average, never had one twentieth part of coin to redeem the bank bills put in circulation; hence, the subsequent failures and terrible loss to bill holders. True, now and then one would demand gold or silver for his bank notes, but forty-nine out of fifty were satisfied; indeed, preferred paper. If the people had at any time required the banks to pay specie, they would, almost every one of them, have "busted." Suppose those who borrowed of the bank had represented that their securities were sound, and it proved to be a falsehood, they would have subjected themselves to criminal suits, for obtaining money under false pretences. But the banks can cheat the people by misrepresentation, and when exposed go unpunished. Is it right for banks to claim that they will redeem their bills when it is not in their power to fulfill these promises when put to the test? Who knows the number of banks that turned out "stump tail" or

"red and yellow dog?" Who can estimate the enormous amount lost by the people through these pompous specie paying banks? Eternity alone can reveal the trouble, anguish and distress to millions who toiled, caused by fraudulent specie paying banks. In 1836 the the banks in Boston failed for thirteen millions. The loss fell principally upon the laboring classes. The owners of the banks, in their palaces, go unpunished.

In 1837 the fraud of specie paying banks became more prominent. Eight or ten banks in New York city concluded to suspend; the banks in this country and Canada followed. Millions of these bills carried on their face, "This bank promises to pay the bearer or order on demand five or ten dollars." In 1880 the general banking law in Michigan created banks that flooded the State with their money and in a few months collapsed, and distressed the people to the tune of $15,000,000. What a damnable fraud! The toiling millions have to grin, suffer and bear it all. Are the people blind, or under-witted? We have had experience enough to get our eyes open. The truth is, no banking system can be permanently established that promises to redeem in specie. The national banks to-day are the best we ever had. They are generally sound because founded upon the principle we advocate, viz. the credit of the nation. This point we regard as proven. In another article we shall show that the government should do all banking and loan at two and one half or three per cent. This accomplished, we shall have a safe and

equitable monetary system. But to the question, gold and silver a fraud. How many thousands of banks that secured the deposits of the people, represented to the bank commissioners (borrowed of their neighbors and returned the same before the call of the commission) showed more specie in the vaults than belonged to them. By this trick they were reported sound. The people had confidence and made their deposits until hard times compelled the banks to close their doors and finally pay off depositors from 10 to 80 cents on the dollar. How many banks robbed themselves forsooth, claimed to have lost heavily, or all, in order to swindle depositors? It is not uncommon for banks to have their pimps, and although they have the people's money on deposit, are often "hard up-money close." But John Smith, their stool pigeon, is loaning for Eastern parties. Uncle John looks very wise and says money is very scarce, a party East wants him to loan for them. As he will be to some trouble, he must have 10 per cent or 5 per cent, as the case may be, for getting the money, i. e., will let the humble suppcant have $900 for a term of years, at 10 per cent semi-annually, provided he gives his note for $1,000 with gilt-edge security, or will shave good notes if well secured. It does seem as if the dear people like to be bulldozed.

From the bank commissioners' report, shown in the tables of treasurer, of the banks in New York City 1844 and 45, we find the average indebtedness $106,931,004; average specie, $9,119,001. Now deduct specie and a balance of $97,812,003, which was canceled by paper. Right

here, it will be seen, a big screw was loose. Fifty "saints" in Wall street could have collected a large proportion of the banks bills and demanded specie of the banks. This would have forced the banks to suspend and sell their state bonds at a discount of from 15 to 40 cts. on the dollar to get gold. Those "saints" would have made a fine speculation in buying the bonds with their gold. This would have created a panic, disturbed all business relations and plunged again the people into hot water. This has been done, and will be as long as the absurdity shall obtain that gold and silver shall be a basis of a paper currency.

Now, can the $3,772,500,000, of coin in the world represents the $19,048,000,000 of indebtedness of the people of the United States? As paper money must represent indebtedness it should rest upon the wealth of the nation. As labor is capital, pays all debts, produces the increase, and as money is not capital, but simply represents capital, labor should have honest money, and wonld have if Uncle Sam should deal it out. Why is money called "capital"? It does not produce increase or accomplish anything. It represents labor that accomplishes all things. Money does not add wealth to wealth any more than other *measures*. The measure does not add to the wheat, neither do weights add to coffee or tea. It is labor that makes money increase. Money, a commodity, absorbs seven-eights of surplus production. What would you think of a half bushel that takes 7 bushels out of 8 for measuring the same? Our monetary system backed up by the laws of the land, and

Sherman's army to protect said laws, is the most bare-faced fraud ever perpetrated in civilized society. In his "wealth of nations" Adam Smith, the great political economist says: "Labor it must always be remembered and not any particular commodity or set of commodities is the real measure of the value of both silver and gold and all other commodistes." On this point the Chicago *Telegraph*, Oct. 2, hits the nail on the head.

"With labor the standard of value, and dollars simply the standard measurement of values, the people will little care whether the yard-stick of measurement is paper, silver, or gold. In enlightened countries the object and use of money is not to represent the value intrinsically, but simply to effect the exchange of products. Whether the money be bread tickets, or barber tickets, greenbacks or blackbacks, silver or gold; if the products are exchanged, the object is accomplished for which money is created. Wealth represents the vast accumulations of labor. So much labor produces so much gold, or so much wheat. Ship both to England, and the wheat and the gold are alike weighed on a scale and purchased at a price fixed by the God of the universe, according to the law of supply and demand."

Untrammeled by this artifice that recognizes only the labor represented by so much gold, and ignores the labor represented by so much wheat, this great law of supply and demand, directed by the wisdom of Jehovah, would neither rob the poor man of his hire, nor the rich man of his wealth.

With a nation, according to the latest estimates, worth the labor requisite to produce in gold, seventy-five billion dollars, the proposition known as resumption now is to adjust our monetary system on a basis which recognizes the labor only which is necessary to produce, and dig out of the earth one hundred and fifty million dollars in gold. In other words, the proposition is to give the gold digger only the royal privilege of coining the products of his labor into money—while the coal digger, the lead digger, the iron digger, and the potato digger are no more to be allowed to coin their labor into money. But the National Greenback-Labor Party, like a plumed knight, like a mailed warrior, springs to the rescue of labor robbed of its divine prerogative of equal rights and equal laws, and says to the coal digger, the lead digger, the iron digger, the potato digger, and all men who dig with muscle or brain from bounteous nature the products of wealth. "Go, freeman as you are, brothers in the common family of humanity. Go, demand of the treasurer of your common country that he coin also the products of your labor, and print it upon paper and name it a greenback, and declare it a legal tender for the payment of all debts both public and private hereafter to be contracted. And let this greenback, the joint obligation of all, with all, bearing no interest, taxing no industry, be the bond of our unity as a nation; the symbol of gold labor, the coal labor, and hand labor, and brain labor, coined into money, attesting the death of that barbarism which hid in the earth its "one" talent of gold and the life and the ac-

tuality of that Christianity of faith in the labor, the honest common patriotism of all, which renders "two other" and "five oth"er talents of plenty of happiness, of intellectual and material progress to the master—the God and keeper of us on the day of reckoning. And who doubts that freedom and greenbacks, inseparably connected andfast bound up in fortune and by fate with the destiny of our republic—that arose like incense of blessings from the alter of our country, drenched with fraternal blood and fratricidal gore—will, when rightly presented and properly guarded, secure to our nation from the King of the universe the grand applaudit: "Well done thou good and faithful servant, thou hast been faithful over few things, I will make thee ruler over many things."

And the sails of your commerce
Shall stud every sea,
And the horn of My bounty
Shall be turned out on thee;
While the steps of thy mansions
Like those of old Job.
"Shall run down with butter"
And feed the whold Globe;
While the wheel of thy industries
Shall grandly turn round,
As freedom and plenty
And Greenbacks abound.

CLINTON COUNTY, IOWA.

Our county officials inform us that two-thirds of the real estate in this county is mortgaged, and that chattel mortgages are being recorded fearfully by the farmers, to pay the interest. Now, let us candidly examine the state of affairs in our county. The assessed value ($\frac{1}{3}$) of the real estate in Clinton county is $6,145,442. This amount would make the real or supposed value $18,436,326. Two-thirds of this amount, $12,-290,884, is covered by mortgage. The exact amount we cannot give, but will approximate with a margin against us. It is believed that in very many instances the property is mortgaged for one-half or two-thirds of its value. But, suppose we assume that the average is one-third of its value; this will give us $4,096,-961. In seven years at 10 per cent., compound, it will amount to $8,193,922. In fourteen years, $16,387,844. In twenty-one years, $32,775,688, and in forty-nine years it will amount to $524,411,138, when the assessed value of the whole State of Iowa, real and personal, in 1877, was only $404,000,000. No wonder the farmers grunt at ten per cent., compound. The deplorable condition of the farmers in this, will apply to every other county in the north-west. If contraction continues, which the money power demand, farmers will very soon be obliged to mortgage their household furniture and tools to pay the interest.

Before the war, in 1859, the recorder of this county told us that about seven-eights of the farms in the county were mortgaged, and in all probability a majority would be obliged to give

up their farms. Fortunately for them, a civil war of tremendous proportions loomed up. Necessity, as usual, forced the nation to expand—issue plenty of money based on the wealth of the nation. Our agricultural and manuacturing interests took fresh courage, all hands were producing wealth. Remember, surplus production is wealth, not money. After the war, in 1866, the recorder of this county told us that nearly all of the mortgages on farms had been paid. The farmers rightfully seemed lords of the country, many of whom, being out of debt, and having toiled hard, began to expend money for some of the luxuries of life.

The next thing we hear from the money power is "contraction," which means death. We must get back to the (old fraud) specie basis. We began to contract, and now what is the result? During the war 100 pounds of pork brought $10. Now it takes three or four hundred pounds to bring the same amount. As usual contraction cheapens production and labor. This always injures the producer and benefits the money loaner. Those farmers who got out of debt of right began to improve their homes and secure some of the comforts of life. This required money, and they borrowed, by contraction; they find that after paying taxes, their help, etc., they cannot sell their productions to pay the interest. Hence the piling on of chattel mortgages. The hard shells, who advocate the gold and silver fraud, say that the farmers have been extravagant, that they have purchased costly farm machinery, pianos and organs, and have run in debt, and now cannot

pay the interest. Gracious God! If there is anyone on earth who needs to make home inviting it is the farmers. "All work and no play makes Jack a dull boy." The monotony of a farmer's life needs something to make home cheerful. The money loaner, who never produces a thing to benefit society, can live in his mansion, have pianos, organs, fast horses, and everything his heart desireth. Why this great disparity between producers and non-producers? It is owing to contraction and high rates of interest. Now nearly all farm products are ten per cent lower than in 1860. If contraction and the old monetary system shall continue, a majority in this country had better give up their farms than contemplate living slaves. A monetary system that robs producers and supports non-producers in luxury, is unjust and devilish. This system was introduced by the Prince of darkness, for the good book says, "Every man should eat, drink, and enjoy the good of all his labor, it is the gift of God." If the farms mortgaged in this county were to be sold to-morrow who could buy them? The money power. What would they give? They would probably give less than their claim, to hold the labor of their victims, perhaps for life. He who borrows money of loaners under our present monetary system, which is a necessity in order to do business, steps into a spider's web, to be bled by feelingless spiders. Are the big spiders to blame for being smart and geting all laws in their favor? We say No. The blame rests upon the producers themselves, who permitted the enactment of laws to oppress the

sons of toil. In two years, if the people do their duty at the ballot box, an equitable financial system can be inaugurated that will equally distribute property. The following question should be discussed in every lyceum and around every hearth in our land: "*Resolved*, That interest on money is the cause of moer misery than any other evil on earth."

"FIAT" MONEY.

What does "Fiat" mean? Webster defines it "let it be done; a decree; a command to do something." All money—gold, silver, paper or copper, is fiat. A decree by the nation makes money, whether paper or gold, fiat. The money monarchs of the world declare that the intrinsic value of the gold fiat is the true money of nations. The people declare that the paper fiat, based upon the credit of the nation, viz., the soil, gold, silver, and all other things intrinsic, is the honest money of the world. A war between Gog and Magog, the gold fiat vs., the People, or paper fiat, will become universal all over the civilized world. So far as answering the real purpose of money, we declare the gold fiat a fraud. During the 400 years of prosperity in Venice its paper money was fiat, for the government so decreed. During England's greatest prosperity, from 1797 to 1820, necessity required Parliament to declare that the paper fiat take the place of the defunct specie fiat. During the French revolution in 1848, as

usual in time of trouble, the specie fiat gave out. The government took the matter in hand and decreed that the Bank of France issue an increased volume of paper fiat money, which kept up the industries of the nation. Both England and France suffered in their industries when they returned to the gold fiat. History repeats: In 1870-71, when France was woefully defeated by Germany, the government was compelled to suspend the gold fiat, and rely on the true and national paper fiat. The increase of circulation was hundreds of millions of francs. To-day her finances are better than those of either Germany, England, or the United States. During our civil war the specie fiat could not be relied on; but the government was forced to issue paper fiat, and with it we whipped the South and saved the Union. God bless the papeper fiat money! We need it now, for our industries are languishing. But it seems the fiat of Wall street is stronger than the fiat of Congress. The onward march of time will surely prove that the paper fiat will be omnipotent.

OLD BEELZEBUB.

It was not enough for the serpent to tempt Lady Eve to partake of the forbidden fruit, which justice required God's fiat: "In the sweat of thy face shalt thou eat bread." But to increase mans' misery, Old Beelzebub whispered in the ear of the Jews, *selfishness*, (that is the trouble in this world,) to rob labor of its

fruits, by collecting the certificates of production, and charging interest on an indespensable tool of toil. To make the grip more sure, officials of the government were bribed to make interest legal. Old Beelzebub, prince of devils, beats the world. Producers, remember the ballot box, if you would enjoy your own and be happy.

HEARTS—GIZZARDS.

The money loaners of Clinton county, Iowa, are gentlemen, whom we seldom hear of overt acts. (beyond what is legal,) in crushing the producing power of the county, but this is an exception to the rule. There is no business on earth so admirably calculated to transfer natural hearts for stoney gizzards, as the loaning of money. Wrong on the start accumulates wrong on the journey. Hence, money loaners become brazen faced, and have no sympathy or mercy. The only question with them is : "What can I make out of my fellow man by loaning him money ?" The shaving of good paper, drawing the legal interest, especially mortgages, from 10, 20, 30, 40, and even 50 per cent., from the man whose necessities require money to transact business, is worse than highway robbery. No wonder so many of our business men fail, and become demoralized. These money loaners have no respect for any body, except those who have property, from which they can suck blood. The "lame ducks," that were once somebody,

are now mere dogs in the community. This vast army of "dogs" will set up a howl, bye and bye, that will terrify Shylock. He may wish he had never been born. The poor, ignorant boys, educated on the street, consequent upon the present state of affairs, covet glory in wiping out this bloated arristocracy. It is a necessity. We hope that it may be accomplished at the ballot box, and for this we shall labor. Remember, moral means, not physical force.

USURY THE ROOT OF ALL EVIL.

In brief, the historian informs us that the Jews were first to violate God's law in reference to usury. We mean the taking of money for the use of money. While they were forbidden to take usury from their own people, they did occasionally from strangers. The laws of the Saxon and Norman kings confiscated the property of those who took usury. Usury was then defined: "To lend money in the hope of gain." This natural and Divine law was inforced until the reign of Henry the VIII, in 1530. About this time certain wealthy Jews made England, especially London, their centre of operations. Subsequently John Calvin, the great scholar and reformer, who exerted an influence among the courts of kings, indorsed and accepted the idol of the Jews, viz., the taking of usury. Laws were passed allowing interest on money, and many of the Jews became immensely wealthy, especially the Rothschilds. Usage changed the

meaning of the word usury. Now usury is defined as taking interest above the legal rates. Before this epoch, begging and poverty were scarcely known in England. But since then the fluctuation of the money market by those who controlled it at various times the people have been forced to "eat sea weed and rob hog troughs," for subsistance. It's terrible and heart-rending to the producers of the wealth of England. Usury and high rents of land have made Ireland the great poor house of Europe.

Blackstone's Comment, Book 2, page 458, says: "The school divines have branded the practice of taking interest as contrary to divine law, both natural and revealed, and the canon law proscribes the taking of even the least increase, for the loan of money, as mortal sin." During the reign of Louis XIV, in France, many wealthy Jews and Calvinites went to Paris and set up the first "fifteen banks," in that city. They made friends with the King by loans of money to carry on successful wars. The nation was involved in debt. Taxes, tariffs and usury were unbearable. This departure from the good old paths required scheming in hope of being relieved of debts and interest; hence the East India Company, the settlement at Madagascar, and other enterprises, to effect usury abroad as well as at home. On the whole, usurers were not satisfied. Now the money power ruled the civil, legislative and military, just as Wall Street rules in this country. The people robbed began to mourn and complain. A small cloud, as the mariner sometimes discovers on the smooth ocean, and as we now see in Ger-

many, arose to fearful dimensions, it culminated in the reign of terror. History repeats itself. Like causes produce like effects. We predict that usury will produce the reign of terror in Germany, the United States and England.—The life of King William, a good man, and that of Bismarck, the great statesman, are in jeopardy. If the leaders are banished from Germany and they come to this country, the ball will be set in motion here. If so it will commence in New York and white-capped mountain waves will sweep over the nation from Portland to the Golden Gate. England, a conservative government, will be the last to suffer, for usury, or interest, is only from 3 to 4 per cent. As the $19,000,000,000 of indebtedness drawing interest in our county is all the producers can possibly bear, and as the money power is only 3 per cent. to the whole, they own more property than the 97 per cent. of producers, it would be a stroke of wisdom if the usurers would now withdraw from dictation, for they have enough to support themselves and their children in luxury through life. They should not interfere with the people, who want plenty of "Fiat" paper money, with reasonable interest. If they continue to crowd the mourners, they must accept the consequences.

HOW TO GET BIG INTEREST.

"He that hath pity upon the poor, lendeth unto the Lord, and that which he hath given,

will he pay him back again."—PROV. 19—17. This truth is proclaimed all through the Scriptures. So he who desires "big interest" should never oppress, but help the poor, for the Lord will pay him at least 10 per cent. daily, compound, through all eternity. Will he, who by usury oppress the needy, receive any interest hereafter? This is not for us to judge, but for the creator of all things to determine. Remember, he who acknowledges a common brotherhood, does all in his power to help and elevate the distressed, will be rewarded by the common Father of all.

LOSSES BY BANK FAILURES.

Report from the Secretury of Treasury, Feb. 11, 1841.

The capital of 20 banks failing between 1789 and 1811, amounted to.....	$3,000,000
From 1811 to 1830, 195 banks failed with an aggregate capital of.....	$36,787,309
From 1830 to 1841, the capital of 150 banks broken or failed amounted to.....	$45,000,000
Thirty banks failed in the Southern and Western States, with an aggregate of.....	$12,000,000
The whole number, 395, and their whole capital	$96,777,309
Losses by the community through the depreciation of bank paper during the suspension of specie payment, from 1814 to 1817.	$7,500,000
Whole loss from 1814 to 1817.....	$22,500,000
At the suspension of 1837, the whole circulation out, was about.....	$150,000,000
The whole loss from 1837 to 1838.....	$44,000,000

At the suspension in 1839, limited to the country South and West of New York, the circulation out in that part, was about..... $75,000,000

The whole loss from 1839 to 1841..... ..... $22,000,000

Losses by banks which have failed since 1789, *computed on their capital, circulation, deposites, and balances owing.*

1. The whole capital of broken banks since 1879, is estimated at.... .... $96,787,309

The probable loss is computed at..	$43,393,654
In other cases. the loss is computed at..... ..	$24,196,827
This would make the loss on capital.....	$72,590,481
Loss on capital..... $72,590,481	
Loss on circulation..... 18,147,620	
Loss on deposits, &c 18.147,620	
The whole loss by failures would then be.....	$108,885,721

Aggregate losses since 1879, *to the people through the existence of banks and use of bank-paper.*

1. Losses through banks that have failed since 1789, on their capital, circulation, and de-deposits $108,885,721	
2. Losses by depreciation on bank notes through suspension of specie payment.....	95,000,000
3. Loss by destruction of bank notes.....	7,121,332
4. Loss by counterfeit notes	4,444,444

Summary.

1. Losses by bank failures.....	$108,885,721
2. Losses by suspensions of specie payment by banks. and consequent depreciation of their notes	95,000,000
3. Loses by destruction of bank notes by accidents.....	7,121,332
4. Losses by counterfeit bank notes, beyond losses by coin.....	4,444,444
5. Losses by fluctuations in bank currency affecting prices, extravagance in living, sacrifices of property.....	150,000,000
Aggregate computed.....	$365,451,497

"It has been the practice, in most parts of the country, to put banks into operation chiefly upon the stock notes of the proprietors. By reports of the Legislature of Massachusetts, in 1838, it appears that many of the banks in that State, which are generally as safe as any in the Union, have been put into operation upon the naked promissory notes of the stockholders, with little actual capital, excepting that which has accumulated from the operations of the banks. These promissory notes are the principal basis of the paper currency issued in the first instance If confidence should happen to be buoyant for a succession of years, the interest on the currency paid in advance, compounded as it always is at short periods, enables the stock notes to be withdrawn without the application of any capital whatever, by the original stockholders."

LEVI WOODBURY,
Secretary of the Treasury

To the President of the Senate of the United States.

Three hundred and sixty-five millions, four hundred and fifty-one thousand, four hundred and ninety-seven dollars lost by the failures of specie paying banks from 1786 to 1841—52 years. Poor, deluded Americans. After throwing off the British yoke, put on a more galling one. The loss has been greater from 1842 to 1879—37 years—which will be shown when we get officialy the details. Hard money is the greatest fraud Satan has ever had the impudence to palm off on honest toil. Uncle Sam's Bank, based upon the production of 45,000,000 of people, will not fail.

GREATEST TRICK OF SATAN.

To secure a network of laws whereby drone bees take all the honey, and in case the workers need a little to sustain life, they must by rigid contract not only pledge reserved but fu-

ture labor to fulfill agreements, when by failure from sickness or otherwise, the drones take all, and turn industry out in the cold. This truth is Santan's masterpiece.

KENO.

A, B, C and D stake their money at keno. The banker, who holds the stakes, sets upon his cushiond chair and dcelares A, "keno." After taking out 10 per cent. he forks over the balance to the winner. A, according to the rule, cannot sneak out, but must give the others a chance. If the crowd continue the play long enough, the banker takes all in the pot. Interest in time takes all a man hath. The latter is legal ; the former illegal.

CREDIT.

Credit is a necessity. No man anticipates pay in advance for labor to be performed, therefore he gives his employes credit. No school teacher presents his or her bill to treasurer of school district, before services are rendered. Our legislators do not demand pay from State or Nation for services in advance. They trust the State and ask pay when the work is done. Credit, therefore, is a national obligation. Too many abuse this credit, which is an injury to themselves and others. It should be remembered that all the wrong we commit in life is the abuse of what was intended for good, Human

law, allowing money to increase exorbitant interest, taken out in advance, when it does not possess any accumulating power, is the greatest wrong ever inflicted upon our race. Our law makers will please look into this matter, and report to their constituants.

UNITED STATES BONDS.

The following comprises all the Treasury notes, legal tenders and other species of money issued by the United States during the war, from 1861 to 1865:

TREASURY NOTES OF 1861.

Description of money.	*Am't Issued.*
The act of March 2. 1861, (12 Stat. 178) authorized the issue of $35,000,000 of Treasury notes, to be received in payment of all debts due the United States, including custom duties, and were redeemable any time within ten years. Amount issued.....	$35,364,450

DEMAND NOTES,

The Act of July 17, 1861, (12 Stat. 259) authorized the issue of $50,000,000 of Treasury notes, not bearing interest, payable on demand. The Act of Feb. 12, 1862, increased the amount authorized 10,000,000 all of which were made full legal tenders by Act of March. Amount issued	$60,000,000

SEVEN-THRTIES OF 1861.

The Act of July 17, 1861, (12 Stat. 259) authorized a loan of $250,000,000, part of which was to be in Treasury notes, with interest at 7 and 3-10 per centum per annum, payable three years after date. Amount issued..... ..	$140,094,750

LEGAL TENDER NOTES.

The Act of February 25, 1862, (12 Stat. 345) authorized the issue of $150,000,000 United

States notes, not bearing interest, payable to bearer. These notes to be a legal tender, except for *interest* on the public debt and duties on imports. Act of July 11, 1862, authorized an additional $150,000,000 of these notes. Act of March 3, 1863, (12 Stat. 710) an additional $150,000,000. Of this class of notes there were issued..... $915,420,031

CERTFICATES OF INDEBTEDNESS

The Act of March 1, 1862, (12 Stat. 352) authorized the issue of certificates of indebtedness (got up in the form of money) to public creditors, who might elect to receive them to bear interest at the rate of 6 per cent. per annum. The Act of May 17, 1862, (12 Stat. 370) authorizing the issue of these certificate in payment of disbursing officer's checks. Interest and principal payable in lawful money. Amount issued $561,753,241

FRACTIONAL CURRENCY.

Total amount authorized..... ..... $50,000,000

ONE YEAR NOTES.

Act of March 3, 1863, (12 Stat. 710) authorized the issue of $400,000,000 Treasury notes, with interest not to exceed 6 per cent., redeemable in three years, principal and interest payable in greenbacks, and to be legal tender to the extent that greenbacks were. Amount issued..... $44,520,000

TWO YEAR NOTES.

The Act of March 3, (12 Stat. 710) authorized the issue of $400,000,000 Treasury notes interest 6 per cent., principal and interest payable in greenbacks, after ten years, and to be legal tender at their face. Amount issued..... $166,400,000

COIN CERTIFICATES.

The Fifth section of the Act of March 3, 1863, (12 Stat. 711) authorized the deposit of gold coin and bullion with the Treasurer, and the issue of certificates therefor, in denominations the same as United States notes; *also authorized the issue of these certificates in payment of interest on the public debt* and directs their *receipt in payment of duties on imports.* Amount issued..... $562,776,400

COMPOUND INTEREST NOTES.

The Act of March 3, 1863, (12 Stat. 709) authorized the issue of $400,000,000 Treasury notes, with 6 per cent. compound interest, payable in lawful money, after three years, and to be a legal tender at their face value. Amount issued..... $266,595,440

SEVEN-THIRTIES OF 1864 and 1865.

The Act of June 30, 1864, (13 Stat. 218) authorized the issue of $200,000,000 *Treasury notes* of not less than $10 each, payable at not more than three years from date, or redeemable at any time after three years, with interest at not exceeding 7 and 3-10 per cent. per annum.

The Act of March 3, 1865, (13 Stat. 408) authorized a loan of $600,000,000, and the issue therefor of bonds, *or Treasury notes*, bearing 7 and 3-10 per cent. interest per annum.

These were all issued in the form of Treasury notes, and were paid out as money to soldiers nd other employes of the Government. Amount ssued..... $829,992,500

WAR BONDS FROM 1861 TO 1870.

LOAN OF 1861.

Act of July 17, 1861 (12 Statutes, 259) authorized the issue of $250,000,000 bonds, with interest at not exceeding 7 per cent. per annum, redeemable after twenty years. Amount issued $50,000,000

The Act of Aug. 5, 1861 (12 Stat., 313) authorized the issue of bonds with interest at 6 per cent. payable after twenty years from date, in exchange for 7.30 notes issued under Act of July 17, 1861. None of these bonds were to be issued for a sum less than $500, and the whole amount was not to exceed the whole amount of the 7.30 notes. Amount issued..... $139,321,200

FIVE-TWENTIES.

Act of February 25, 1862, (12 Stat. 345) authorized a loan of $500,000,000 for the purpose of funding the Treasury notes and floating debt of the United States, and the issue of bonds therefor, with interest at 6 per cent. These bonds were redeemable after five years and

payable in twenty years from date. By Act of March 3, 1864, the amount of bonds was increased by $11,000,000, and the Act of Jan. 28, 1865, by $4,000,000. *Interest* payable in coin. Amount issued..... $514,771,600

TEN-FORTIES OF 1864.

The Act of March 3, 1863, (12 Stat. 709) authorized the issue of $900,000,000 bonds at not exceeding 6 per cent. interest, redeemable after ten years, and payable not more than forty years from date.—*principal and interest in coin.* Amount issued..... .. .. $75,000,000

TEN-FORTIES OF 1864.

The Act of March 3, 1864, (13 Stat. 13) authorized the issue of $200,000,000 bonds, at not exceeding 6 per cent. per annum, redeemable after ten years and payable not more than forty years from date. *Principal and interest payable in coin.* Amount issued..... $194,567,300

FIVE-TWENTIES OF MARCH, 1864.

The Act of March 3, 1864, (13 Stat. 13) authorized the issue of $200,000,000 bonds, at not exceeding 6 per cent., payable after five years. Amount issued..... $3,882,500

FIVE-TWENTIES OF JUNE, 1864.

The Act of June 30, 1864, (13 Stat. 217) authorized a loan of $400,000,000, and the issue therefor of bonds, redeemable not less than five nor more than thirty years (or forty, if deemed expedient) from date, with *interest in coin*, at not exceeding 6 per cent. per annum. Payable semi-annually. Amount issued..... ..... $125,561,300

FIVE-TWENTIES OF 1865.

The Act of March 3, 1865, (13 Stat. 468) authorized the issue of $600,000,000 bonds or Treasury notes. The bonds to be for not less than $50, payable not more than forty years nor less than five. *Interest payable in coin* at 6 per cent. per annum or 7.30 per cent. if paid in currency. Amount issued $203,327,250

CONSOLS (5-20s) OF 1865.

The Act of March 3, 1865, also authorized the issue of $600,000,000 bonds (or Treasury

notes) in addition to previous amounts, the bonds to be for not less than $50, payable in not less than five nor more than forty years. *Interest at 6 per cent in coin or 7.30 in currency.* Amount issued... ... . $332,998,950

CONSOLS OF 1867.

The Act of March 3, 1865, (13 Stat. 468) authorized the issue of $600,000,000 bonds, or Treasury notes, in addition to amount previously authorized. The bond to be for not less than $50, payable from five to forty years, with interest at 6 per cent. if paid in coin, or 7.30 it in currency. Amount issued..... $379,616,050

CONSOLS OF 1868.

The Act of March 3, 1865, also authorized the issue of $600,000,000 bonds or Treasury notes, in addition to amount already authorized. The bonds to be for not less than $50 payable from five to forty years. interest semi annual, at 6 per cent, in coin or 7.30 in currency. Amount issued..... ..... $42,539,350

The last three issues of consols were for the purpose of absording and funding the legal-tenders and greenbacks. They were the contraction bonds and used for that purpose.

No Act under which their issued authorized their payment in coin, and even the interest was payable in currency by the addition of one and three-tenths per cent.

FUNDED LOAN OF 1881.

The Act of July 14, 1870, authorized the issue of $200,000,000 bonds at 5 per cent. interest, $300,000,000 at 4½ per cent. and $1,000,000,000 at 4 per cent. *Principal and interest payable in coin.*

The Act of January 20, 1871, increased the amount of 5 per cents to $500,000,000.

The object of these bonds was to take the place of the 5.20's. which under the law, were not specifically payable in coin.

About half of the 5.20's have already been funded in these bonds, and the balance are being so funded as fast as the exchange can be made.

EDUCATION.

It appears to us that the essence of the Bible is summed up in the following: "Love God with all thy heart, might, mind and strength, and love thy neighbor as thy self." If we love God we will admire his works and study his laws. Nature's laws are absolute. God never concedes, for he is always right. Human laws change; are often repealed, and others substituted, because man is falable. If we love our neighbor as our self, we will "do as we would be done by." Upon these two duties "hang the law and the prophets." To learn to do right is the chief or real education of life. As we have said before, "do right, for one with God is a majority." Question.—When money loaners foreclose on an unjust mortgage, though *legal*, and turn father, mother and little children out in the cold, is that doing as we would be done by? Our children should be taught that we were created to help each other; that with hand and head they should produce equivalent to what they consume; that if they would be happy they would try to make others happy; that interest on money is the cause of most of the misery on earth, and that the improvement of every latent power, so as to secure a symetrical development, is a duty they owe to themselves and to society. In short, the education of our youth should be compulsory, and they should be restrained until good habits become second nature. As no skunk on this globe will drink whisky, chew tobacco or swear, children should be restrained until they are of age. Last, but not least, that the human race were created for

a higher life, and to worship a just and omnipotent God, instead of the golden calf of earth. An education that qualifies for eternal life, is all that is really intrinsic in this world. If there is no hereafter, this life is a farce, and a curse to a majority who labor, in consequence of devouring interest. Some new political party, like the former Abolitionists, should educate the people to throw off the galling yoke of the money despot.

HOMES LOST.

Is it true that 200,000 farmers in Nebraska, Kansas, Texas and Northern Iowa will lose their farms in consequence of mortgages and devouring interest? If the virgin soil of this country could only keep clear of the jews or shylock, what a prosperous and happy nation we would be.

TERRIBLE.

We are informed that loan and trust companies in the East hold mortgages on farms in half a dozen states in the Mississippi valley of over $300,000,000, drawing 10 per cent., compound. Thirty millions of dollars per annum of the surplus production of said states are transferred from western farmers to the money princes of our land. It seems as if there is a harmonious alliance between the money power of Wall

Street, New York, and London, Great Britain, to rule the people of each country with a rod of iron. Our laws transfer ¾ of the surplus production of the people into the hands of the feelingless few. There is danger of the producing power, now owning lands and homes by deeds of fee simple, loosing all. It is a duty government owes to itself to control the finances of the nation; to issue all the money needed for business purposes, loan the same at rates of interest in harmony with labor, and the profits to be placed to the credit of the people. There would be a law, that will not only make it criminal, but confiscate the property of any who deal in money. The right inheres to producers of wealth to control the same.

ECONOMY.

A, a capitalist, owns a mansion that cost $10,000; furniture, $3,000; piano, $2,000; oil paintings, $1,000; span of horses and carraige, $600. He expends $1,000 for food and clothing annually. He goes to all the lectures, concerts and to a few shows, which is all right, because he pays for his enjoyments.

B carries the "tin pail"; works 300 days at $1.50 per day, which earns for him $450 per annum. He pays out for himself and family 75 cts. per day for food, $225 per year; house rent at $8¼ per month, $100; clothing for self and family, $100; church expenses, $18; Taxes, $4; oysters once and one basket of peaches, $1.25; occasionally Harper's Monthly, Frank Leslie and Ledger, $1. Total, $449.25.

This is the most favorable side for the "Tin Pail."

It will be seen that B, by not attending lectures, concerts or any shows, not even subscribed for a news paper, has saved 75 cents per annum above necessary expenses. Now, if B's daughter gets a fancy bonnet, or a cheap organ is brought into the house, the money loaner says B is extravagant, and that he should econ-

a higher life, and to worship a just and omnipotent God, instead of the golden calf of earth. An education that qualifies for eternal life, is all that is really intrinsic in this world. If there is no hereafter, this life is a farce, and a curse to a majority who labor, in consequence of devouring interest. Some new political party, like the former Abolitionists, should educate the people to throw off the galling yoke of the money despot.

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omize, for he has no right to the luxuries of life, unless he can pay for them. How did A come by his property? Ans.—He inherited it, or by "superior executive ability" obtained it. Now, let us see. A never produced or earned a dollar in his life, to add to the nation's wealth. How did he get such a colossal fortune? Ans.—By excessive rates of interest, or by speculating on the labors of others; if in land the labor of the many made his land valuable. B is a producer, and adds to the wealth of the nation. A never produced any thing, but a few extravagant children, and reared some pointer pups. That B has no right to any of the luxuries of life, unless he shall exercise the most rigid economy, don't read straight in my Bible.

OUR MONEY SHOULD STAY AT HOME.

Money, produced in the United States, should remain at home to aid those who produced it. Any custom or law, whereby one nation can take the money of an other, injures that nation in the same proportion that it benefits itself. The money of this nation represents the property of this republic. Balances against us injure our circulating medium. Thus balances in our favor help us. The true theory is that each nation is entitled to the use of its own money for its own benefit. Therefore, a paper currency, based on the productive wealth of the nation, is better than gold or silver. The real currency, a paper medium of exchange,

should be such that it will not wander off, like the prodigal son, but stay at home for the use af the American family. This would not only be in harmony with natural law, but would aid American industry. The United States posses-es every facility for securing subsistance, comfort and happiness. If our wives and daughters desire silk dresses, we have something better—cotton and woolen goods. Imported wines are a curse rather than a benefit. Coffee and tea can be cultivated here. If a wall could be built as high as heaven and as low as the centre of the earth around our nation, provided always that there be one double gate to let in the oppressed of other nations, who have been distressed by the money power, having stationed at the gate a strong police force to stop every dollar going abroad for the necessities or luxuries we can produce at home.

GUARDIAN FOR UNCLE SAM.

While we are dependent upon our fellow man, owing to the interlacing of human interests, man should mainly rely upon himself for the common necessaries of life. What is true of an individual is true of a community, body politic, state or nation. Our government when in distress, needing money to preserve its life, should rely upon itself, instead of advising through Belmont with the Rothschilds, who would dig up the bones of Christ, if upon the earth, and demand gold of the christians, or

even skin the devil for his hide and tallow. The Rothschilds when advised of our necessities, looked very wise and said: "If the government will issue bonds, and not tax them, put them on the market we will furnish the gold." The bonds sold for about half their face, and will be redeemed for 100 cents on the dollar, with interest in gold. It does seem as if the Rothschilds and their allies are bound to skin the people of the United States. Is Uncle Sam an idiot? He certainly needs a guardian.

TAXES.

SYNOPSIS OF THE IOWA TAX LAW.—Taxes become due on the first of November, and delinquent on the first of February. On the first of March one per cent. interest is collected; first of April two per cent.; first of May three per cent.; first of June five per cent.; first of July seven per cent.; first of August nine per cent., first of September twelve per cent.; first of October fifteen per cent.; first of November eighteen per cent., and three per cent. per month thereafter. On the first Monday of October of each year the lands are sold for taxes, when a further penalty of twenty per cent. attaches, and that with the principal, draws interest at the rate of ten per ct. per annum on the first of March. After the sale the purchaser has the right to pay subsequent taxes and collect *the same penalty and interest as on the sale.*

This law by authority of the State of Iowa, oppresses the poor, whose homesteads are sold, and who would, if it were possible, pay promptly these taxes. This would not be so galling if paid to the State instead of to usurers. If any man can show any state or nation that has a more usurious law this side of brimstone, please report. Our next legislature should reform some of the errors upon our statutes.

"LAME DUCKS."

Interest has made more human "lame ducks" than powder and shot ever did of the feathered tribes. Our laws require producers by their labor to support non-producers; to perform impossibilities, hence the litigation in all the courts.

UNCLE SAM, BANKER.

We have statistics showing that about six hundred million of dollars have been lost to the United States within the last hundred years by the failing and swindling of specie paying and savings banks. The failure of business firms consequent upon the money derangement, viz., hard times, panics and revolutions have been double. The same course in the future will produce the same result. The only cure for this terrible evil is to change the money power from the greedy few to the government. Money exerts almost an omnipotent power. The temptation to cheat, swindle and deceive is too great to be controlled by selfish non-producers. Its abuse is almost an absolute certainty. Those who make the money (the representative of production) of the nation, the right inheres in them to control the same. As the prosperity and wealth of the nation depend upon labor, it is a duty the government owes itself to control the money in a manner that will encourage production, secure the necessities of life to all who contribute to its weel, especially those

who toil to produce the fruits of earth. The government therefore should issue a currency based upon the soil, gold, silver, copper, lead and iron, (the three last most useful,) and upon all other things intrinsic. This is a sound, natural basis furnished by nature for a circulating medium. This basis would never fail if the people obey "By the sweat of thy brow shalt thou earn thy bread," unless God should send a famine, and in such an event the government, holding the surplus earnings, could distribute to those in distress. Our plan would be something like this, subject to amendment: Uncle Sam banker; the property of the nation, capital stock; the owners thereof, of course, stock-holders. Profits placed to the credit of the people in national, state and county treasuries. As the average profit on labor is from one and a half to three per cent, Uncle Sam, desiring harmony between capital and labor, would not exceed 3 per cent interest on long time with good security.

The government should issue about $50 per capita; loan to States secured by State bonds at one per cent; the State loan to counties at one and three fourths or two per cent. and receive county bonds; the county loan to the people at two and a half, not to exceed three per cent. This would be equitable and secure harmony, sympathy and love between the people and government. Such a system as this would strike a death-blow to communism and socialism, a secret fire-collecting material for an explosion. Postmasters in business localities by giving good security would make good bankers;

the safety and fidelity of the money order arrangement, prove it. Uncle Sam's bank would never fail and all depositing in said bank would never lose a cent. To encourage the poor who wish to lay up their savings it may be policy to give one and a half or two per cent on time deposits To stimulate those who may have a surplus of currency, especially the old man unable to work or do business, the government should issue two per cent. bonds and take up the paper and re-loan the same. Profits of state and county paid into the national treasury to pay the expenses of the government, especially the interest on national bonds. Our views in detail may appear in another book. When a monetary system something like this shall have been adopted, all kinds of business will flourish, manufacturies will start up and be as prosperous as they were in England from 1799 to 1820, when the Bank of England suspended the fraud, specie payment, and issued paper freely. In ten years our shipping would surpass the world and our surplus production feed the globe. All of this, and more too, is in store for us if the government (we mean the people, for they are the government) shall adopt a just and equitable monetary system. In time of war many people do not have confidence in paper money. Especially, then, it is important that the government should have control of the gold and silver of the nation, for the benefit of producers, and those who risk their lives to save the State, instead of a selfish few who contrive all ways to swindle both the government and the people. Even in times of peace this class control

the currency, to the injury of industry. Expansion is a natural law; contraction is death. We should expand, and expand until we have a ship canal from Boston to the Golden Gate, with double locks over the Rocky mountains.

WHAT'S THE MATTER?

While wheat, pork, beef, and nearly all commodities have shrunk one-half to one-third of their former value, and real estate, from which is derived all wealth, now defunct, to adjust themselves to specie resumption the curse of traders and farmers in distress failing every day, interest keeps up and mortgages do not shrink? Why this great disparity? Because legislation is for shylock—the dear people left out in the cold. That's what's the matter.

DISINTERESTED BENEVOLENCE.

Our nation furnishing credit of bonds and then paying national banks to use them, is disinterested benevolence, unprecedented. As usury by the few has created a debt of nineteen billions of dollars, the government ought now to loan its own capital and pay off this indebtedness, for the producers of the wealth of the nation are discouraged.

CHRIST—USURY.

Christ, the greatest philosopher philanthropist and teacher ever upon earth "overturned the tables of the money-changers." "But," says the objector, "we find one or two passages in the Bible that outweigh all others upon usury, viz., Mathew xxv, 27: 'Thou oughtest, therefore, to have put my money to the exchangers, and then at my coming I should have received my own with usury.'" Commentators say "not usury, for that is unlawful interest, and more than the money can produce." As money does not possess any accumulating power the word "usury," as used by our Savior, cannot mean interest. Besides, up to the middle of the fifteenth century, both biblical and profane authors declare that usury was the taking of money for the use of money.

In Luke xix, 22, we find: "Therefore, thou gavest not my money in bank, that at my coming I might have received my own with usury." These two are the only passages in the Bible, that we know of, that admit of a question. Usuers cling to these passages of scripture as law, gospel and physic.

Benson says, in regard to the parable of talents, that it was not customary among the Jews at that time to take usury or interest. The parable means the improvement of all gifts for our own benefit, the benefit of others and the glory of God. This is in harmony with the verses preceeding and succeeding Mat. xv, 27. The servant that had received two talents gained two more, and he who received five talents gained five. His Lord said: "Well

done, good and faithful servant, thou hast been faithful over few things, I will make thee ruler over many things." To improve our talents, genius and skill, as well as add to the "goods delivered to the servants, is sound political economy. It will be remembered that the Jews did not take usury from their own people, but at times were allowed to from strangers.

Clark, in his comments on Exidus xx, 25, on usury, gives its origin, viz., "Neshceh—Hebrew —to bite, cut or pierce with the teeth; biting. In Latin usury is called "Nachach," because it resembles the biting of the serpent, which is so small as scarcely to be perceived at first, but the virus soon spreads and defuses itself till it reaches the vitals; so usury is at first not perceived nor felt, but at length grows so much as by degrees to devour another's substance. That's it. Twenty millions of dry human hides are on the fence, and hundreds of green ones are coming off every day in the United States, caused by interest or usury devouring another's substance.

Webster's Unabridged defines usury: "formerly, interest or premium paid, or stipulation to be paid for the use of money; (usury formerly denoted any legal interest, but in this sense the word is no longer in use.)—Present usage: interest above the legal rates, or interest above the rate of interest established by law." Appleton's Cyclopædia, Vol. 15, page 853, defines usury: "Originally this word meant any taking of money for the use of money, and he was a usurer, who in lending money required in payment any more than the amount which he lent.

This was once considered a great moral wrong. For many ages, however, the opinion, if it has not ceased to exist, has lost much of its practical or legal force. As the lender can oppress the borrower, Christian nations have fixed by law the rate of compensation for the use of money." Chamber's Encyclopædia, Vol. 5, page 606, we find: "A strong prejudice against exacting interest existed in early times, arising from a mistaken view of some of the enactments of the Mosaic law. As late as the reign of Edward VI there was a prohibitory act, for the alleged reason that charging of interest was a vice most odious and detestable, and contrary to the will of God. Calvin, the famous reformer, was one of the first to expose the error and impolicy of this vice."

In Scotland any charge for interest was prohibited before the reformation. We declare positively and absolutely that usury in the Bible from Genesis to Revelations means the taking of money for the use of money. As it is a *measure* of values, no charge should be made, any more than for the use of other measures. But selfish men have taken God's wisdom at a discount. They have discounted and discounted the paper of producers until there is not much left to discount.

We give Martin Luther's views, condensed, who in 1540 wrote a pamphlet admonishing ministers not to take or favor the taking of interest for use of money; that the selfish interests of the Jews, capitalists and rulers of governments were in opposion to the teachings of the Bible; that the taking of interest was usu-

ry, condemned from the first to the last page in the Holy Scriptures; that if allowed it would build up partition walls in society; that a selfish arristocracy would live upon the earnings of industry; that if Christians should imbibe this worldly spirit, the church would lose its hold on the masses, and consequently fail to accomplish the work commenced by the Master; that christianity would lose its prestige and become a part and parcel of the world; that the church will be governed by the wealthy, who will pay tithes with other people's money, extravagant and worldly, to the injury of the poor, whom we always have among us; that law allowing interest is legal robbery, which has and will ever create antagonism in God's beautiful world. Here we give the exact words of this thunder and lightning reformer: "Who will help us now, when shame has got to be honored and crime a virtue. When you let money and take more in return it is usury, and is cursed by the rites. The capitalists say 'everybody takes interest, therefore I can.' The world is cursed and damned for it, and if you adhere to the same you will suffer in Hell with her. You don't benefit your neighbor by lending him money and taking interest. You injure him as you would by stealing from him." Martin Luther's views on this subject ought to be studied carefully by every preacher on this globe.

Calvin opposed Luther on this question. Luther contended that money taken for the use of money was usury, and forbidden in the word of God. Calvin, Luther's superior as a scholar, argued the question scholarly and with great

power; that money is a commodity, and that a man has a right to use his own, as to him seemeth good. Luther clearly showed that money should not be a commodity; that its functions were to measure values, and for a medium of exchange, and that no man has a right to use his own to the injury of others. Calvin's views took with usurers and the money power, which in Scotland, Switzerland and France built up strong and popular churches for him. By means of the money power, Calvin followed the mighty Luther. At this juncture of affairs the scale beam was turned in favor of taking interest, which has grown with the growth and strengthened with the strength of the Christian Church. To-day the protestant church, except one branch of Lutherans, in this country, recognises the right to take interest, and has perhaps more *sharpers*, in proportion, in the church than out of it. This is the reason why the church has lost its prestige. Christ labored to benefit the people in temporal as well as spiritual things. A Baptist missionary in India, by his labor in the famine lately, baptised ten thousand people. If the christian church imitate the Master, in "faith and works," its influence would be ten times greater upon our globe this very hour. Now, the masses do not find a home in the church. They are prejudiced and lean toward infidelity, and their children are being educated to favor "free" Sabbaths. If the church should work for the temporal, as well as spiritual interest of the people, infidelity would be shorn of its power.

The world has too many in the church like the deacon in Iowa, who said he "could not see how a christian could take more than 32 per cent. for use of money in hard times."

We are informed that not more than 1,000 miles from Ripon, Wis., not long ago, an influential Presbyterian deacon loaned money. A widow lady desired to take up a mortgage on her house and lot, and asked the deacon to lend her the money. The deacon said he would, provided she would give him 25 per cent., the rates which he was then getting. The widow said that to pay over 10 per cent. would distress her. The deacon replied, "suppose we pray over it, and perhaps your eyes will be opened." They both knelt down, and the deacon prayed earnestly. The widow consented to pay the 25 per cent.

At Crawfordsville, Ind., in 1840, a responsible citizen, being hard up, called upon a capitalist to borrow $200 for three months. The money loaner said that the times were so awful hard he could not *accommodate*, unless he had big interest. The borrower offered to pay at the end of 3 months just what per cent. the capitalist should think best to take. By this pledge of honor he got the money. At the end of the 3 months, the borrower layed down $400, and told the lender to take all he thought best. The capitalist took $300. At night he told his wife that he had made $100 off his neighbor, and could have made $100 more. She reproved her husband for not taking it. He replied: "Don't you suppose I have the conscience of a christian?"

The truth is, the church has become too worldly. A majority of the people have little or no confidence in church members.

The strength and weight of John Calvin, in favor of usury has built up an arristocracy, at the expense of industry. The Presbyterian church, which is doing a noble work in this world, is not to blame for a mistake of its founder. The money power of the world could well afford to resurect the bones of John Calvin, put the same into a gold coffin and deposit them in Westminster Abby or some other popular place. But there is one difficulty in the way, and that is that his bones in a gold coffin would not be any more safe than A. T. Stewart's. In a usurious country locks, bars and bolts could not protect them. Truly, "the love of money is the root of all evil."

IRISH CONSTRUCTION.

Pat says to Sullivan, "what does 5–20, 7–30 and 10–40 bonds mean?" Sullivan says, "I know all about it—5–20 means to get up at 5:20 in the morning, and work until 7:30 in the evening, so that the banker can lay in bed until 10:40."

JUSTICE.

Bunyon, one of the best men that ever lived, who brought our 10 different characters in his allegory of the pilgrim, was put in Bedford

street jail for 12 years because the laws forbade his preaching the gospel until he stepped in that divine calling "through the right door." Thousands of our race struggling to live and support their families, have been sent to state prisons, because the laws favor the money power. History will bring out facts that will make future generations shudder.

MONEY.

If the government has the right to create money, why don't it pay its debts, instead of saddling a terrible burden upon the people?

THE RAG BABY.

Whenever there is an "over production" why is it that very many laborers are ragged and half starved? Because there is a scarcity of "rag babies." One of the sons of toil said to me: "A few years ago when a 300 pound hog brought $25, I had the money and bought one. Now when 300 pounds of pork can be bought for $8, I have not got money enough to buy a chicken." Who ever knew a dull market when there were plenty of "rag babies?" During the 400 years of prosperity of Venice, in which no panics or revolutions occured, the "rag babies" were $80 per capata. During England's greatest prosperity, from 1799 to 1820, the gold fraud gave out, as it now shows its weakness in

Glasgow and many parts of Great Britain, Parliament ordered plenty of "rag babies." She prospered more during that 21 years, than any half century before or since. In France the gold fraud "busted" several times, and every time the "rag baby" kept up the industries of the nation. As usual when the United States was in trouble, gold and silver sneaked off to the vaults of the usurers. The government was forced to bring forward the "rag baby" to pay soldiers, and by it we whipped Jeff. Davis and saved the nation. God bless the "rag baby," for people everywhere prefer it to gold or silver.

ROTHSCHILDS—RED SHIELD.

At Frankford, Germany, in 1743, there was a Jew named Meyer Anslem. He died, leaving a son, who was bound to become rich. This son packed up his duds and tramped to Hanover, where he engaged as clerk in the office of a money broker. He saved every cent over and above bare subsistance, got married, set up on a small scale in the money broker business, bought up old coin, shaved notes and dealt in jewelry, under the sign of "Red Shield," from which was derived his name, "Rothschild." He seemed to have embodied the spirit of the seven Herods and those Jews who sold Christ very cheap, and hence was a success in getting money. During the wars of that age he seized upon every opportunity to make a fortune by the misfortunes of others, for he was a Jew. No-

bles, Princes and officials of government heavily mortgaged their property, at ruinous usury, to obtain a little money. In a few years he made eight millions of dollars, and died. His will required his five sons to keep together, go into the banking business, take mortgages, deal in government stocks, or anything to make money, provided always they got good security. His sons at the bedside of the dying father, took an oath before a magistrate, that they would carry out the provisions of the will. They do so to the very letter. Each son labored with all his ability in the department of business to which he was best adapted. Nathan, the sharpest, was to "drive" the bargains, another to keep the books, the third to examine securities, &c. In 1798 they set up a "shaving" shop in Manchester, England, and made millions of dollars. In 1803 they went to London, to speculate in government stocks. In the wars with Napoleon England's exchequer was often empty. The Rothschilds, at a very great discount, often bought exchequer bills, turned them over to the government at par, by furnishing money. One of these Jews was on every battle field, and reported by carrier pigion to their house in London, to take advantage on change. They won "on every heat." They gambled with half a dozen aces in hand. This deception and robbery, sharpers call great executive ability in financiering. At Waterloo, Nathan went upon the heights to watch developments. In the afternoon of June 18th, 1815, he saw that the combined armies of Blucher and Wellington were too powerful for the French, and that

Waterloo was won for England. Nathan, who had no thought for the killed and wounded, widows or orphans, mounted the swiftest steeds, stationed for his benefit, and flew to the English channel. The wind blew a gale, and the waves swelled to "mountains high." No crossing! He offered $400 to a skiffman to take him across. At a great risk of his life, he landed on the shore of Dover, thence, without food or rest run down several horses for London, declaring all the way that Waterloo was lost to England. Stocks fell to ruinous prices and their agents bought all they could of those shaking in their boots. In 24 hours news came that England had won the battle of Waterloo. The Rothschilds made in one day five millions of dollars. Those who think Satan can beat that, have a higher opinion of him than we do. This firm will be likely to get up a corner in the regions of brimstone. During our civil war the Rothschilds sent over Belmont to advise our government in finances. Our nation obeyed. The Rothschilds, it is said, hold over one hundred millions of our bonds, purchased at about half their face. Good Lord, deliver us!

ROMAN CHURCH.

It is a cardinal doctrine of the Roman Church not to take usury or interest. If it should now bring "usury" to the front, it would take the world, by being in sympathy with labor.

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ERRATA.

Page 55—"Li'lies," nearly all wrong.
Page 58, 6th line—"house" should be "hour."
Page 58—"substance" should be "subsistence."
Page 60, 8th line—"of" should be "or"; in 10th line "life" should be "money."
Page 63, 16th line—"1880" should be "1840."
Page 101, 11th line—"followed" should be "floored."

NO INTEREST FOR MONEY,

EXCEPT TO THE GOVERNMENT;

THEN NOT TO EXCEED 3 PER CENT.

UNCLE SAM, BANKER:

THE WEALTH OF THE COUNTRY, INCLUDING SOIL, MINERALS AND THE PRODUCTIONS, THE CAPITAL STOCK.

PROFITS PLACED TO THE CREDIT OF THE PEOPLE

AFTER PAYING GOVERNMENT EXPENSES.

SHYLOCK AND HIS MONEY CAST OUT; FOR THE PEOPLE CAN HAVE BETTER MONEY, MORE OF IT, AND A BANK THAT WILL NOT BREAK; ALL DEPOSITS SAFE; NO "HARD TIMES" NOR REVOLUTIONS.

BY W. H. GIBBS, LYONS, IOWA.

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